

Essentials of Innovation and Entrepreneurship

EIE - I

Module M4 - Building/Leading Teams in Startups

CIE Spark 2025: Problem Validation Sprint

The Three-Phase Journey

Phase 1: The Problem Hunt

Your Role: **Individual Detective**

Objective: Identify and document real-world problems you observe.

Key Date:

- **Sep 04:** Phase 1 Template Shared
- ☒ **Sep 10:** Deadline for Individual Submission

Phase 2: Team Formation

Your Role: **Identify & Collaborate**

Objective: Form a multidisciplinary team (4-6 members, max 2 per department) around one problem statement.

Key Dates:

- **Sep 16:** Master Individual Database Shared among with the template
- ☒ **Oct 06:** Team Formation Submission Deadline

Phase 3: The Validation Sprint

Your Role: **Problem Validation Expert**

Objective: Conduct interviews, gather data, and prove your problem is worth solving.

Key Dates:

- **Oct 07:** Phase 3 Validation Template Shared
- ☒ **Oct 24:** Validation Dossier Submission Deadline

Announcing the **Top 10** on **30th Oct** and **Final Pitch** on **3rd November**



THE LAST ONE STANDING

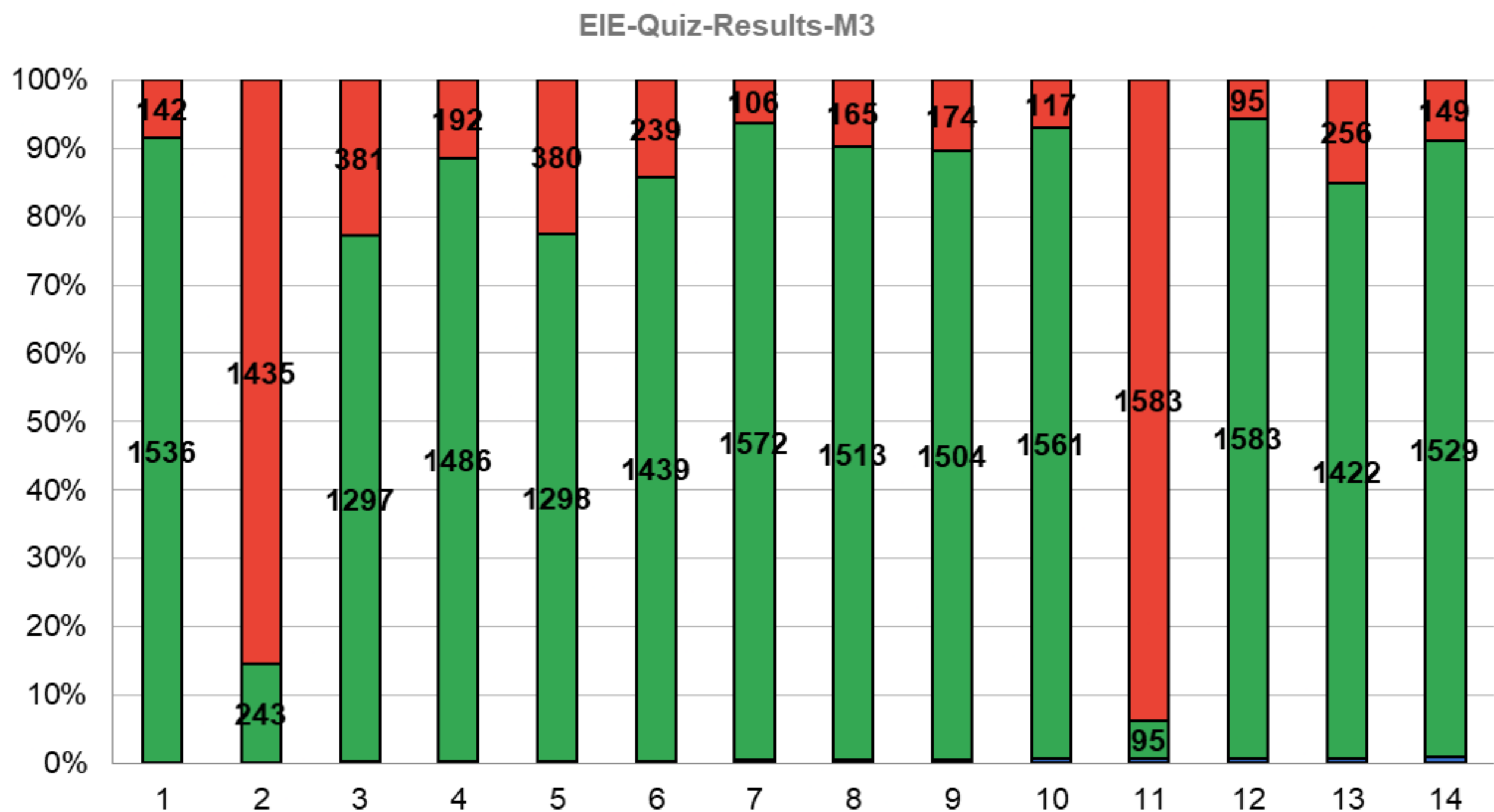
12-13TH SEPTEMBER | MRD BLOCK

Scan here to register



EIE M3 Session – **Poll/Mentimeter Results**

EIE M3 Session Quiz



EIE M3 Session Quiz

2. According to TIPSC, which of the following is not a criteria for identifying a good opportunity?

- a) Timely – The idea should fit the market conditions at the right time.
- b) Important – It should address a real need or pain point.
- c) Profitable – It should have the potential to generate revenue and returns.
- d) Sustainable – It should have long-term viability, not just a short-term gain. – ONLY 243 students got it right!**
- e) Context - It should align with the environment (economic, social, legal, technological)

3. Airbnb was created after noticing what market problem?

- a) High travel costs
- b) Hotels were sold out - 1297 students got it right!**
- c) People wanted shared kitchens
- d) Lack of online booking platforms

7. In the TIPSC filter used in this module, what does “S” stand for?

- a) Scalable
- b) Sustainable
- c) Solvable- ONLY 95 students got it right!**
- d) Social

3 for Thought

India's Silicon Moment

Vikram-32 takes the stage: ISRO's SCL-Mohali unveiled a fully indigenous 32-bit, space-grade microprocessor at Semicon India 2025 and presented it to the PM a real silicon milestone.

India just showcased chips built on home soil. Early days, but the flywheel is turning across design, packaging, and scale—next up: repeatability, yields, and a steady product pipeline.



3 for Thought

Thindy's Smart Kitchen Assistant

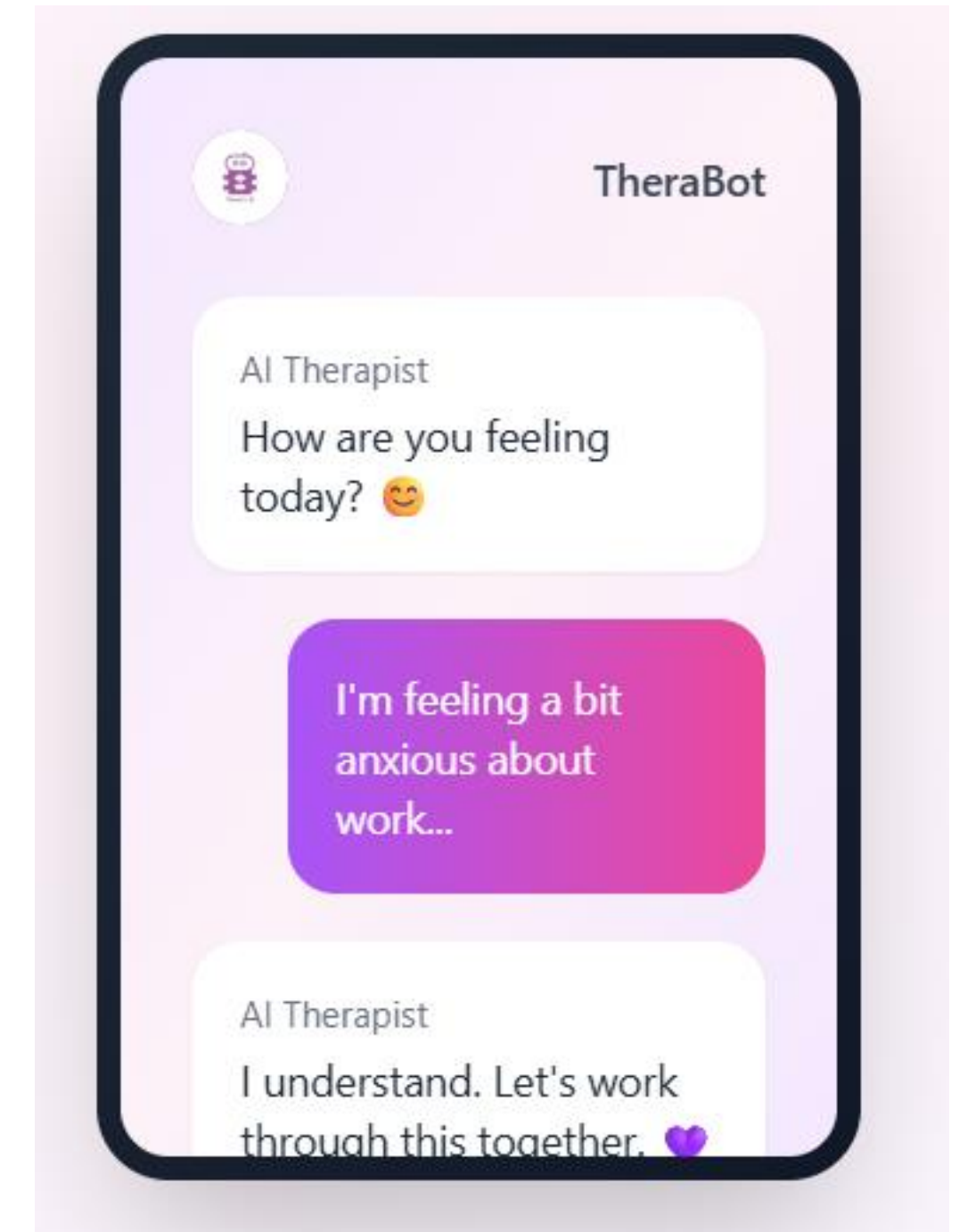
- Robot chef for dosa & omelets, automating the key steps, pouring batter, spreading, cooking, and plating.
- Aimed at cloud kitchens, busy professionals, and home cooks where speed consistency matter.
- Built in Bengaluru.



3 for Thought

Therabot

- A generative-AI chatbot, just cleared a **randomized clinical trial** showing **significant symptom reductions** for people with depression, anxiety, and eating-disorder risk.
- It's a big step toward **evidence-based** digital therapeutics. It's a **helper**, not a replacement for clinicians. Aim is scaling responsibly, and careful real-world rollout.



Today's Topics



Building Teams



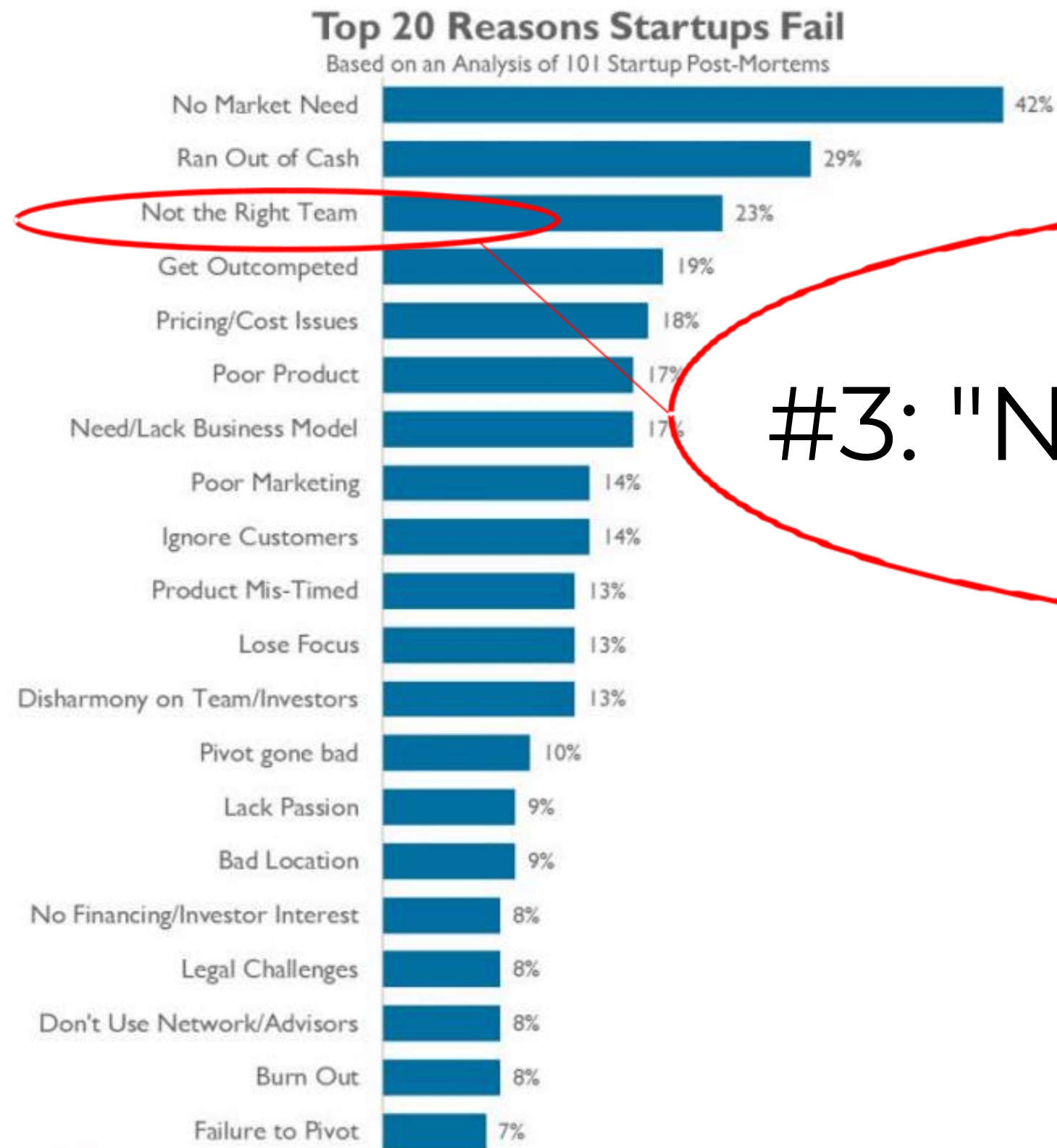
Leading Teams

Credit: Image Creator (Microsoft Bing)

Teamwork



Top 20 Reasons Startups Fail



#3: "Not the Right Team"

Your Idea of a 'Dream' (Perfect) Startup Team?

Mentimeter

Join at www.menti.com

use the code: **6467 6979**



Effective Team Characteristics



Trust

Create & Maintain

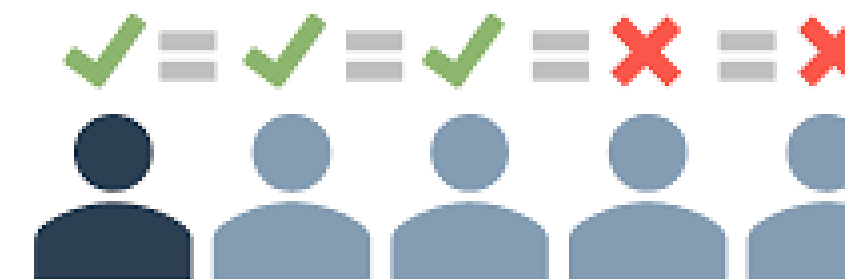


Purpose

and shared beliefs



Good **Communication**:
disagreements handled
well



Most decisions by
Consensus



Clear **Roles/Responsibilities**



Collaborative

Team effort



Diversity

And Inclusion



Teams **Learn & Share**
their learning

What Makes a Good Team

(Simon Sinek, ~2min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uNQkD-Pt0OE)

Building Your Startup: Building Your Team

(Kauffman Foundation, ~1min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3YSgopGo7qE)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3YSgopGo7qE>

Build a Tower, Build a Team (MarshMallow Challenge)

(TED Talk, ~7min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H0_yKBitO8M)

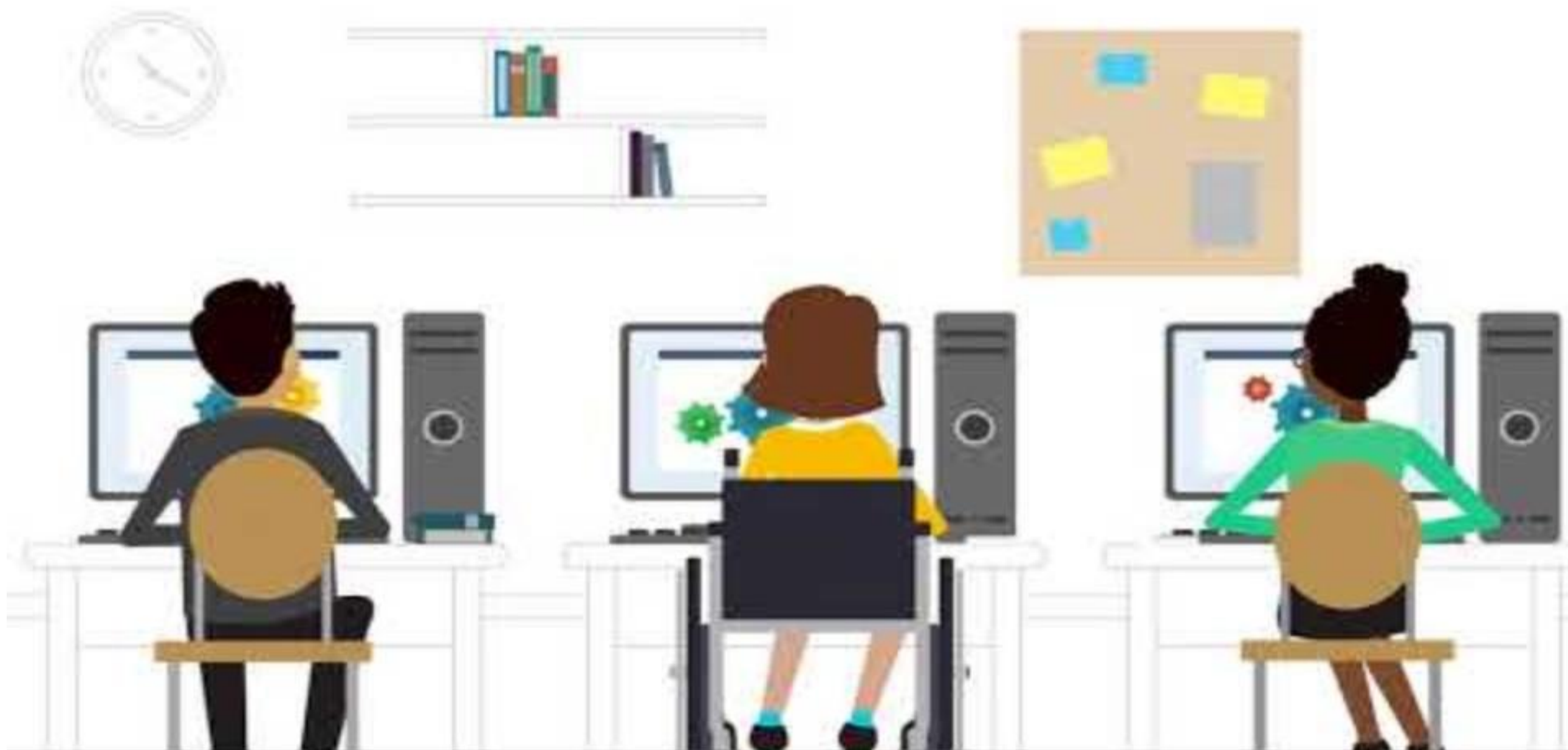
Diversity and Inclusion

**“Diversity is being invited to
the party Inclusion is being
asked to dance”**

Verna Myers

The Power of Diverse Teams

(Microsoft, ~1min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mz9KLOnkT6I)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mz9KLOnkT6I>

Different Types of Diversity in Teams

Mentimeter

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use the code: **6624 1351**



Diversity

Entrepreneurial Diversity (Dimensions):

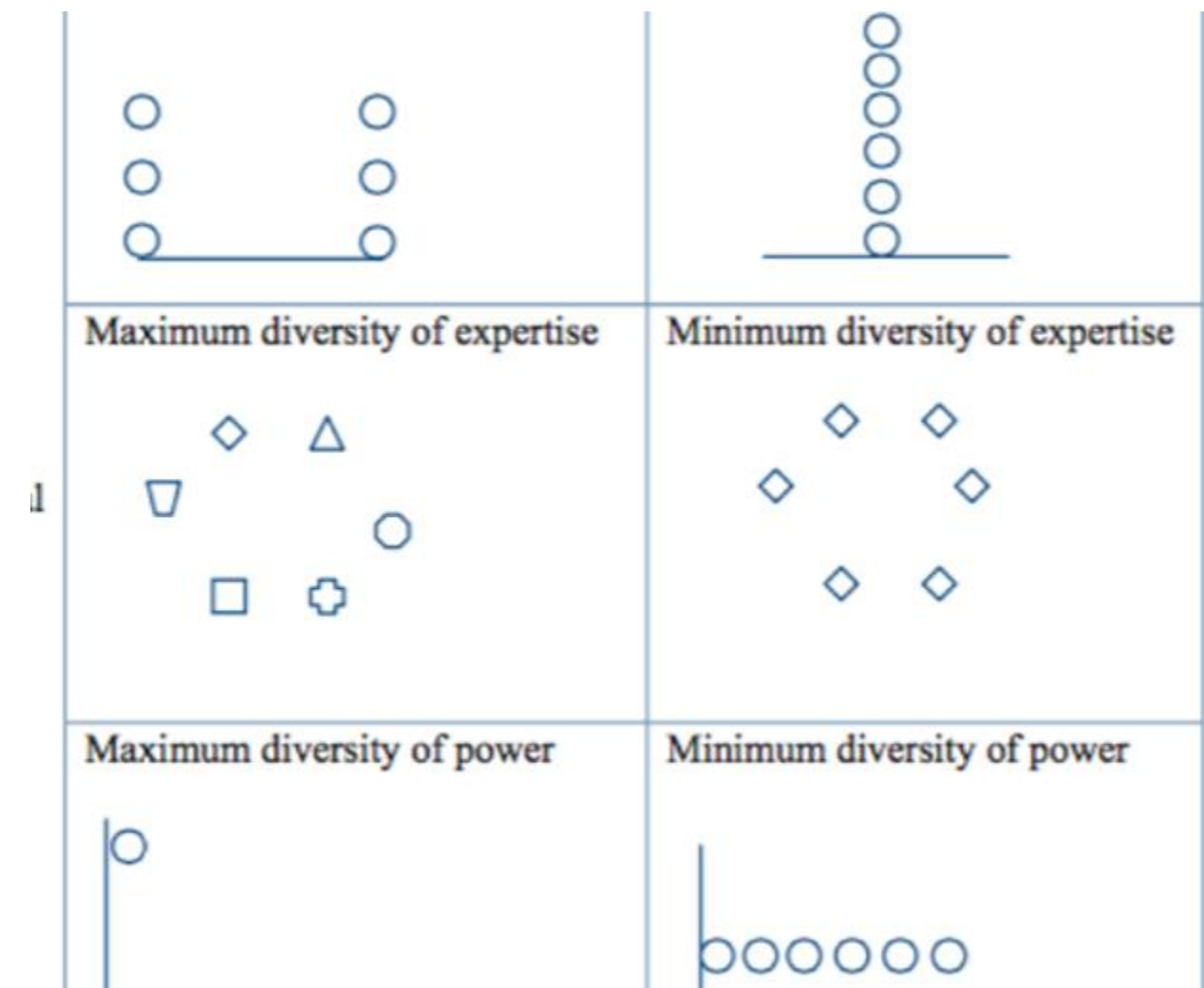
Expertise, Opinion, Power

Optimal Levels of Diversity:

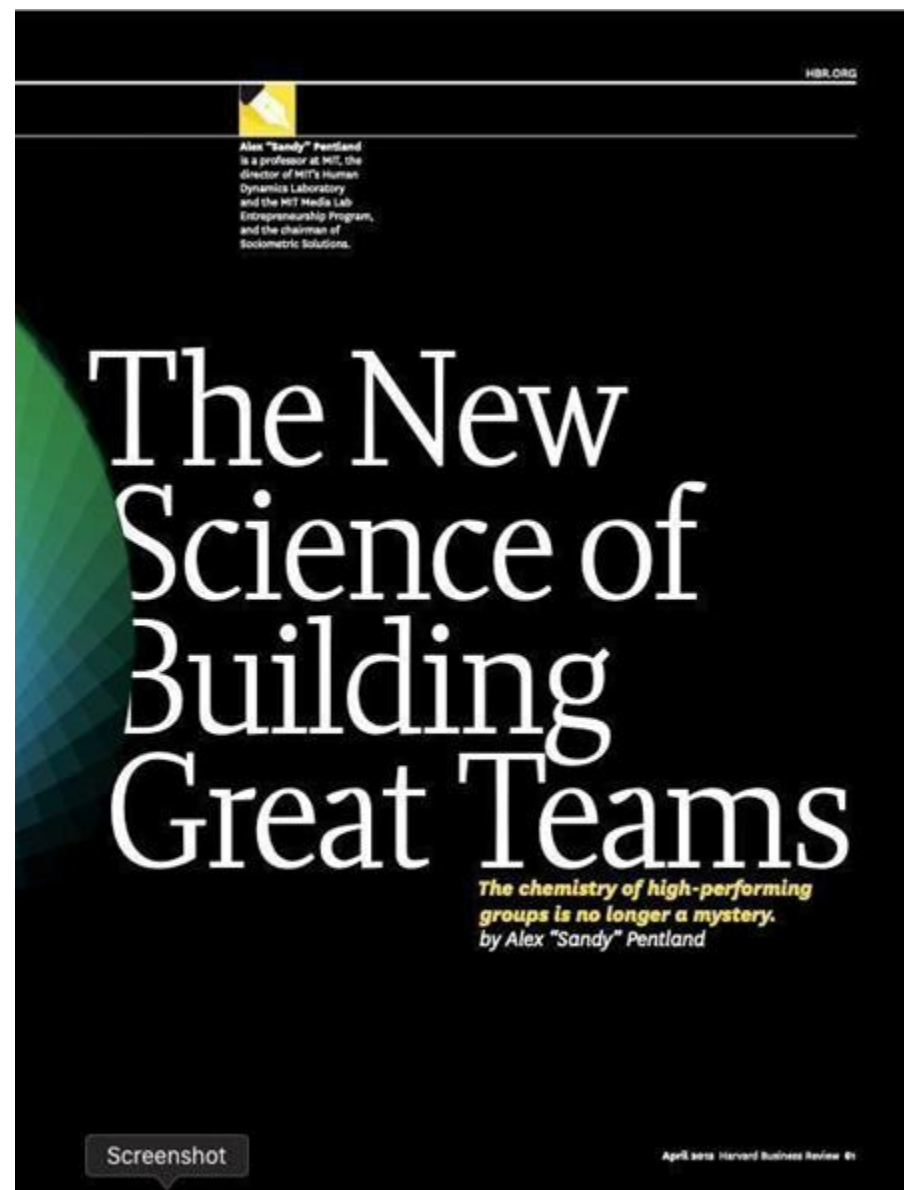
Expertise: High

Opinion: Moderate

Power: Low



Secret of High-Performing Teams



Energy, Engagement, Exploration

“Just by looking at the sociometric data, we’ve been able to foretell which teams will win a business plan contest”

“The most valuable form of communication is face-to-face”

How do you plan to overcome this?
(especially if you are cross-campus/remote)

Early Signs of Dysfunctional Team-Member Relationship

- *Criticism*
- *Contempt*
- *Defensiveness*
- *Stonewalling (refusing to communicate)*

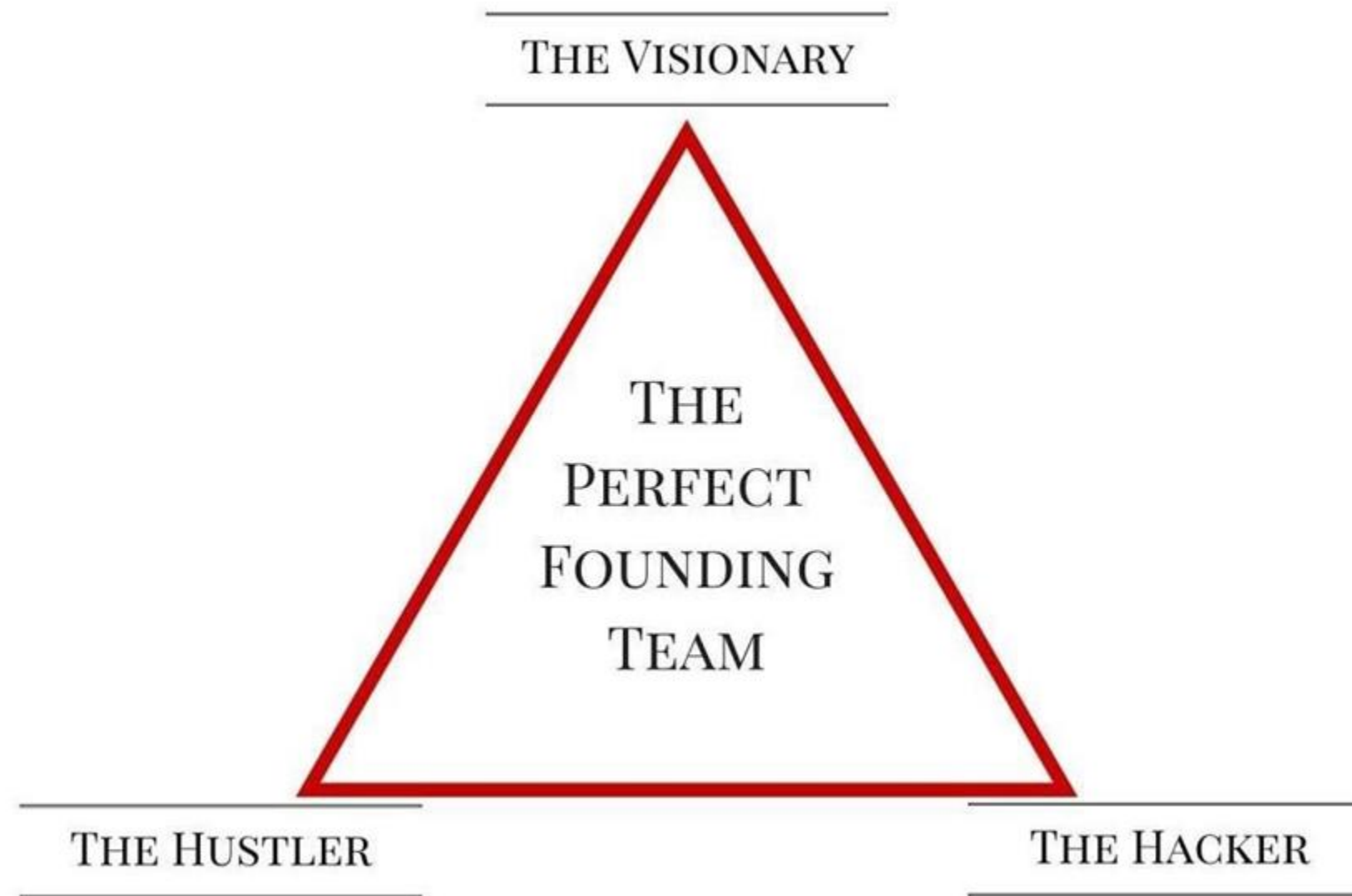
Is there a Perfect Team?

A better question to ask is 'How Do We Work Together'?

- *Everyone fights, so make a plan*
- *Figure out roles, goals, and a process before emotions get involved*
- *Start having hard conversations now*
- *Communicate to share honest feedback without criticism*
- *Pay down emotional debt regularly*

Simplified View: 'Balanced' Founding Team

Key driver to bring the idea to life; Inspires the Team



*Not defined by position/title but by Attitude;
Helps sell the product/solution*

Build the product/solution & anything else needed along the way

Team Roles



Founder(s)

Has the Initial Idea.

May or May not
have a leadership
role



Founding Team

Complementary
skills- Builds the early
firm/org



Founding CEO

Brings order and
create 'Comfort in
Chaos'; Leads the
Company

Guest Lecture



K.Chandrasekhar

Founder & CEO of Forus Health

Forus Health is the brain behind the development of a technology platform that increases access to eye care and prevents avoidable blindness. K Chandrasekhar established a unique strategy to introduce the revolutionary product '**3nethra**', which resulted in an unprecedented expansion of the retinal imaging market in India. Before starting Forus Health, K Chandrasekhar was the Director of Strategy at NXP Semiconductors and served over 20 years in major multinational and Indian tech companies. K Chandrasekhar is an alumnus of BITS, Pilani and IIM Kolkata.

Know Thy Self



Knowing yourself is the
beginning of all wisdom.

~ Aristotle

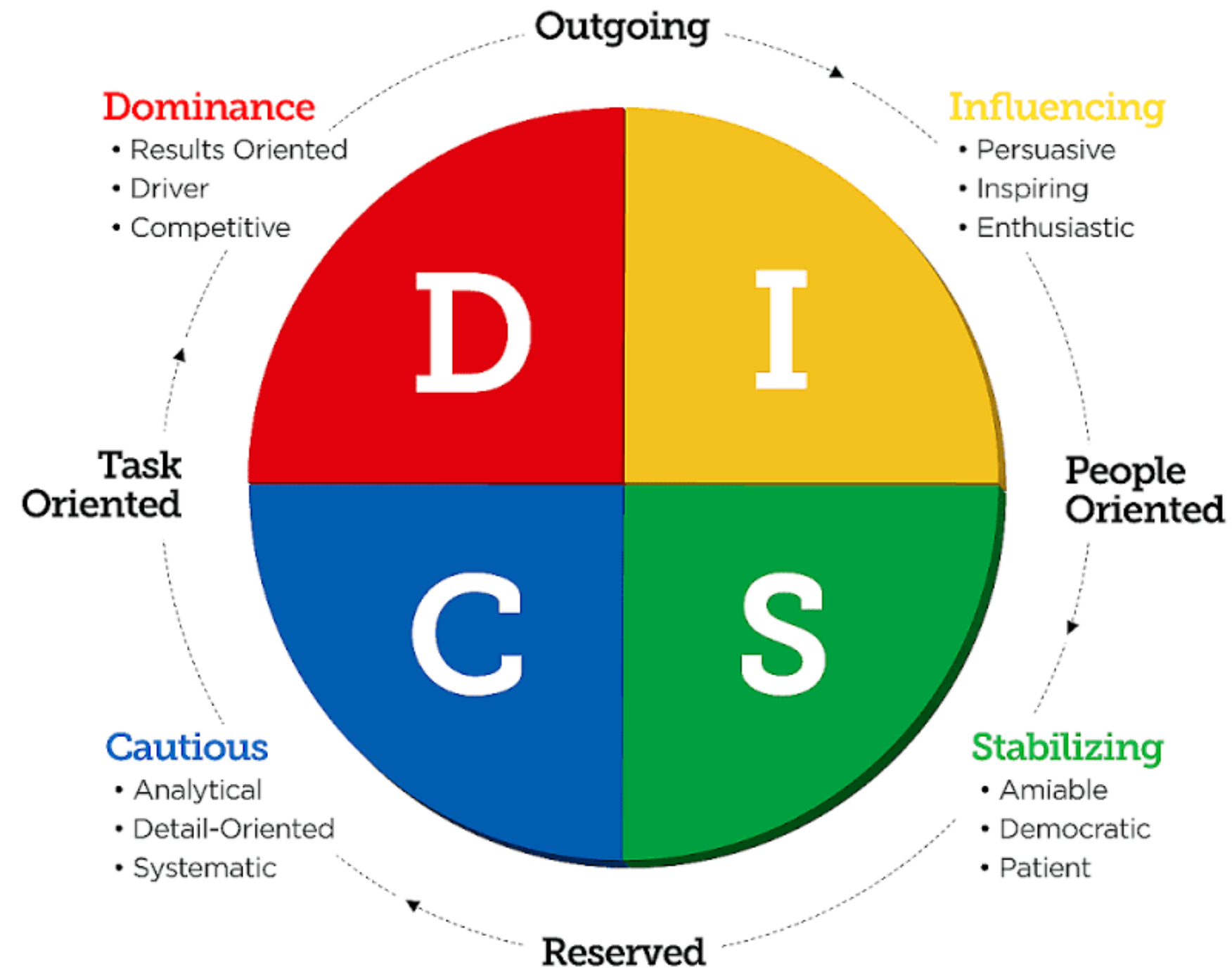
AZ QUOTES



“Knowing others is intelligence;
knowing yourself is true wisdom.
Mastering others is strength;
mastering yourself is true power.”

— Lao Tzu, Tao Te Ching

Personalities (example DISC)



Sample DISC test (checkout others as well):

<https://www.tonyrobbins.com/disc>, <https://professionalleadershipinstitute.com/disc-assessment/>



Leading Teams

Credit: Image Creator (Microsoft Bing)

Your idea of a Good Leader (startup context)?

Mentimeter

Join at www.menti.com

use the code: **1454 1750**



What It Takes to Be a Great Leader

(Harvard Business Review Explainer, ~2 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LU84BFFqKvI)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LU84BFFqKvI>

What Makes a Great Leader (Innovation Context)

(Linda Hill, Harvard Business School, 1st 4 mins)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ME5arjISTGQ)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ME5arjISTGQ>

Leadership – What You Don't Need: Micro-manage

(Movie clip: “Office Space”, 1 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jsLUidiYm0w)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jsLUidiYm0w>

Leadership – What You Don't Need: Unempathetic

(clip from: “Parks and Recreation”, 1 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cRC7ZFiLHmA)

Leadership: Vision

(Steve Jobs, 45 sec)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/shorts/olONVwWg97w)

<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/olONVwWg97w>

Leadership: Listen, Kindness, Respect

(ex-President Barack Obama, ~2 min)

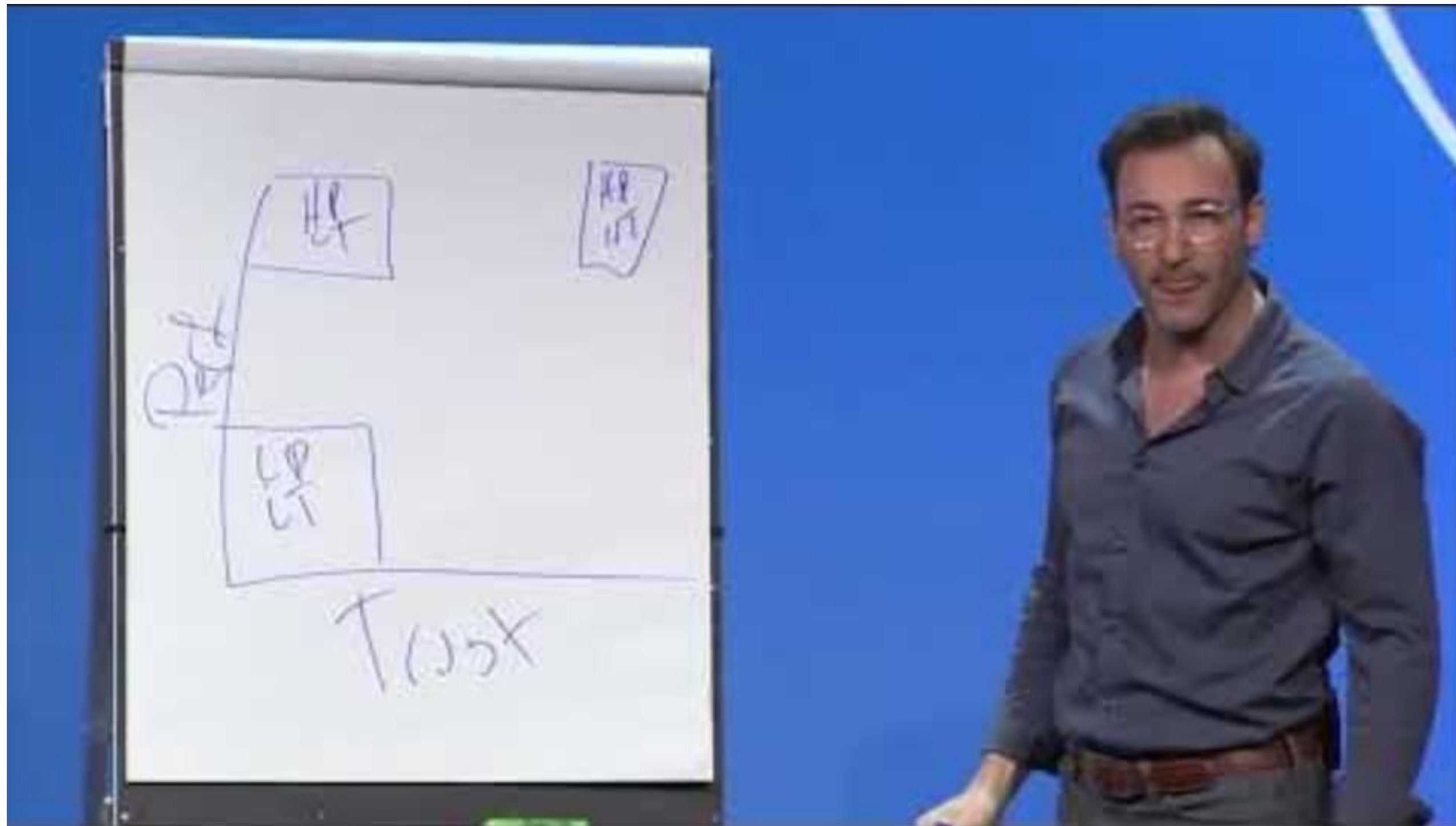


[Video](https://www.youtube.com/shorts/P8XBaOVqg1I)

<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/P8XBaOVqg1I>

Leadership: Trust vs. Performance

(Simon Sinek, 2 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PT09e3ILmms)

Leadership – Taking Care of your Team Member

(Simon Sinek, 1 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/shorts/yBgGG2G9Zyk)

<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/yBgGG2G9Zyk>

Leadership: Empathy, Perspective

(Simon Sinek, first 2.5 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eXDNkwleOqA)

What's *more* important than IQ & Tech Savviness for a Leader?

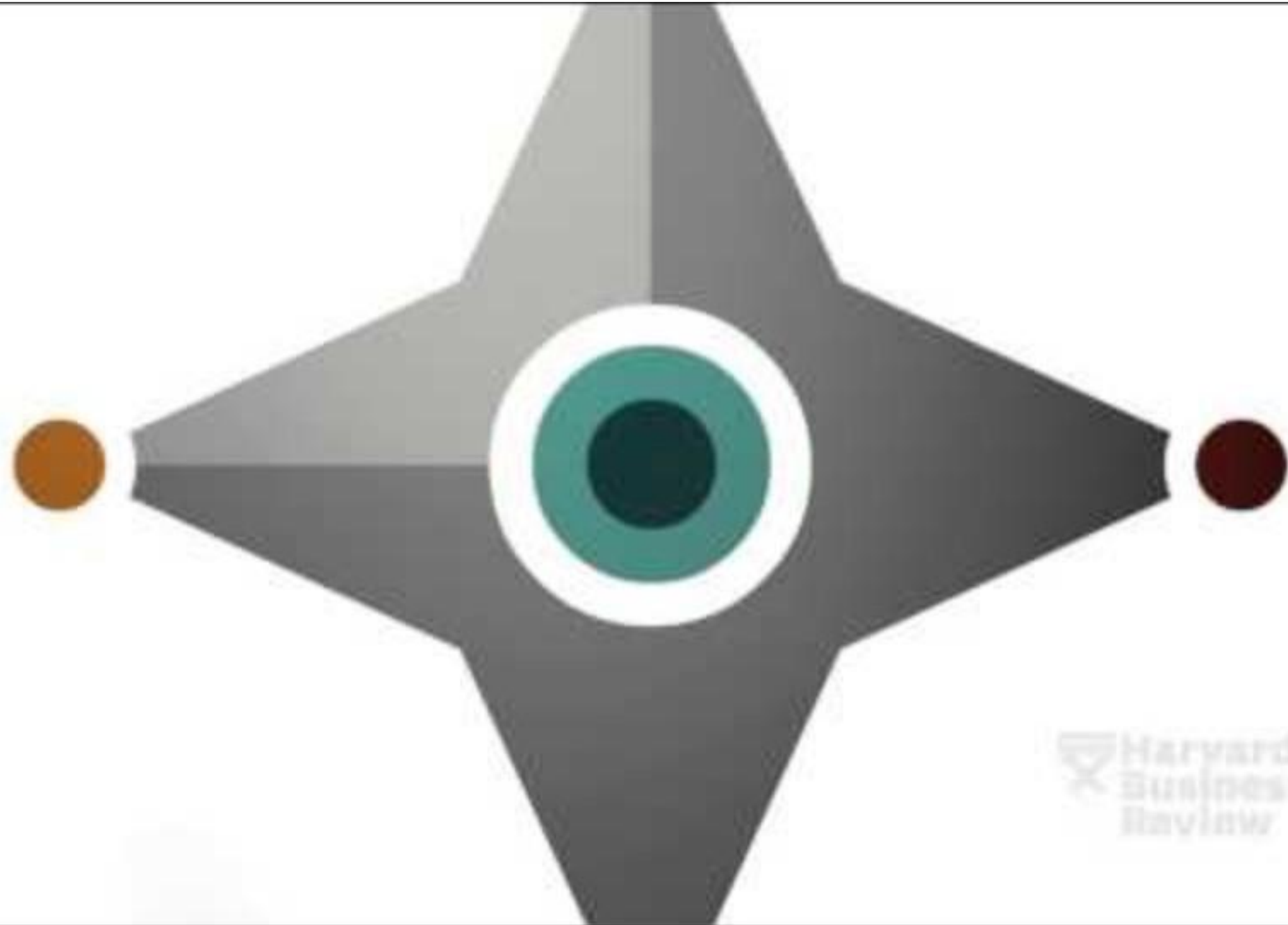
Mentimeter

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What Makes a (Great) Leader

(Daniel Goleman, Harvard Business Review, 4 min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WICq_Pj8ZUk)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WICq_Pj8ZUk

Elements of *Emotional Intelligence*



**Self-
awareness**



**Self-
regulation**



Motivation



Empathy



**Social
skill**

Harvard Business School: See [here](#) for an insightful article

Reading: "The Real Leadership Lessons of Steve



Source: Harvard Business Review: Apr 2012, [link](#)

Summary

- **Top Reason Startups Fail:** One of the top reasons for failure is "Not the Right Team." Ensuring the team has the right mix of skills, leadership, and collaboration is critical to success.
- **What Makes a Good Team?:** Essential components include mutual trust, respect, shared beliefs, and a focus on the organization's success over personal interests. Diversity in skills and perspectives is crucial, and members should approach differences maturely.
- **High-Performing Teams:** Teams with high energy, engagement, and exploration often perform better. Communication, particularly face-to-face, plays a key role in team success, even when members are remote.
- **Team Roles:** In a founding team, complementary skills are vital. The CEO often brings order, providing "comfort in chaos," while other founders may or may not take on leadership roles.
- **Leadership** behavior demonstrated by all team members in a startup can make all the difference between success and failure!

Post-Session Activity: DISC Personality Test

There are several (free) Personality Tests available online. DISC is one of them.

Even DISC is offered (for free) by multiple agencies.

Below are 2 examples (feel free to checkout others):

<https://www.tonyrobbins.com/disc>

<https://professionalleadershipinstitute.com/disc-assessment/>

Note: The accuracy of any psychometric test varies; consider results as 1 perspective, do not view result as definitive!

Reflect on the following:

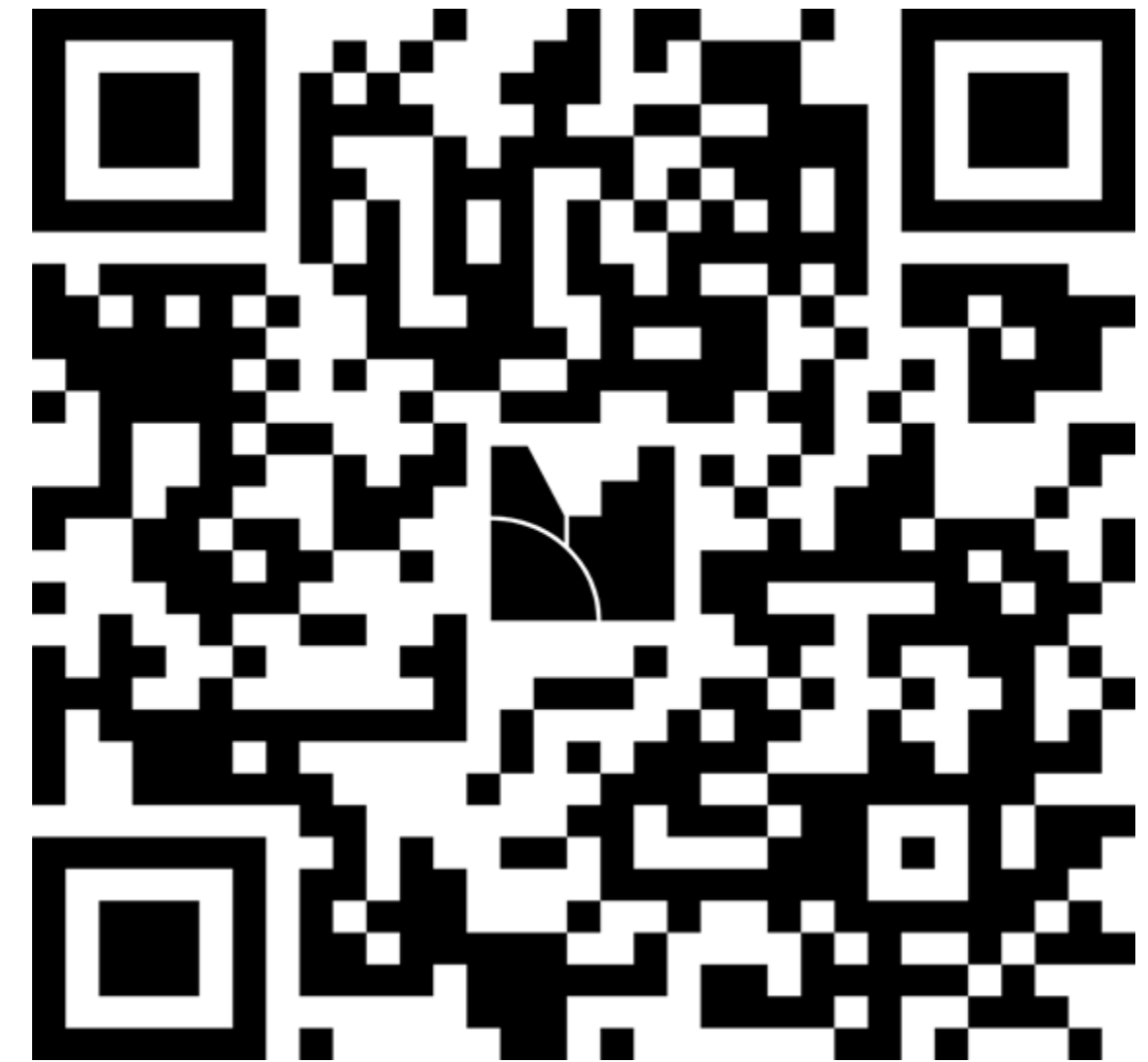
- 1. Do you agree with the results? Analyze what you agree and don't agree*
- 2. Are there areas that you wish to strengthen? Change? Keep it the same?*

Session Feedback

Mentimeter

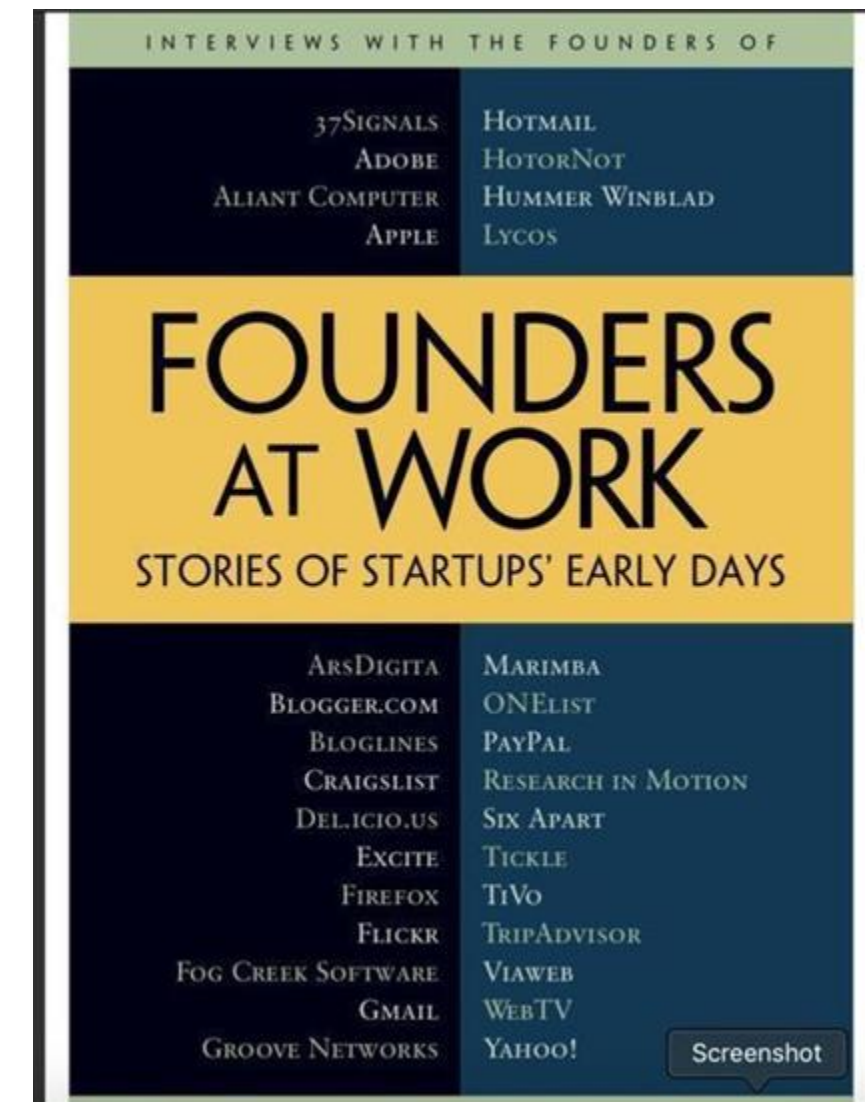
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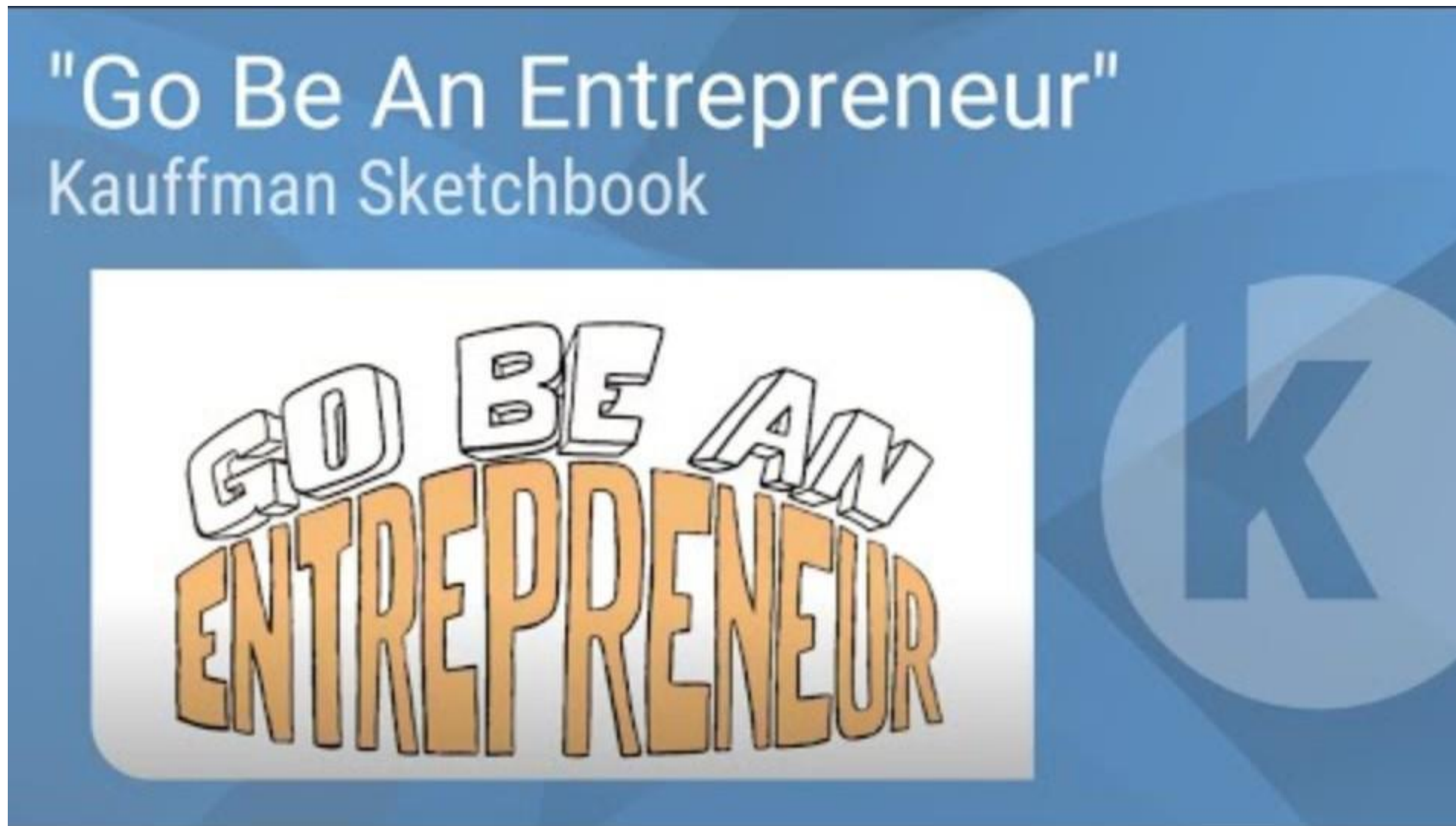


Founder Traits

- Perseverance
- Ability to deal with
 - Failure (another word for ‘learning’)
 - Uncertainty, Isolation, Non-linear progress
 - Rejection (of ideas/beliefs/results)
- Optimistic (‘half-glass-full’)
- Adaptable



Go Be an Entrepreneur: Teams and more (Kauffman Foundation, ~4min)



[Video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?feature=shared&v=FOFm8fPP2Kc)

[youtube.com/watch?feature=shared&v=FOFm8fPP2Kc](https://www.youtube.com/watch?feature=shared&v=FOFm8fPP2Kc)

Session Quiz

Please take the Session Quiz on PESU Academy now!

Thank You!

Essentials of Innovation and Entrepreneurship

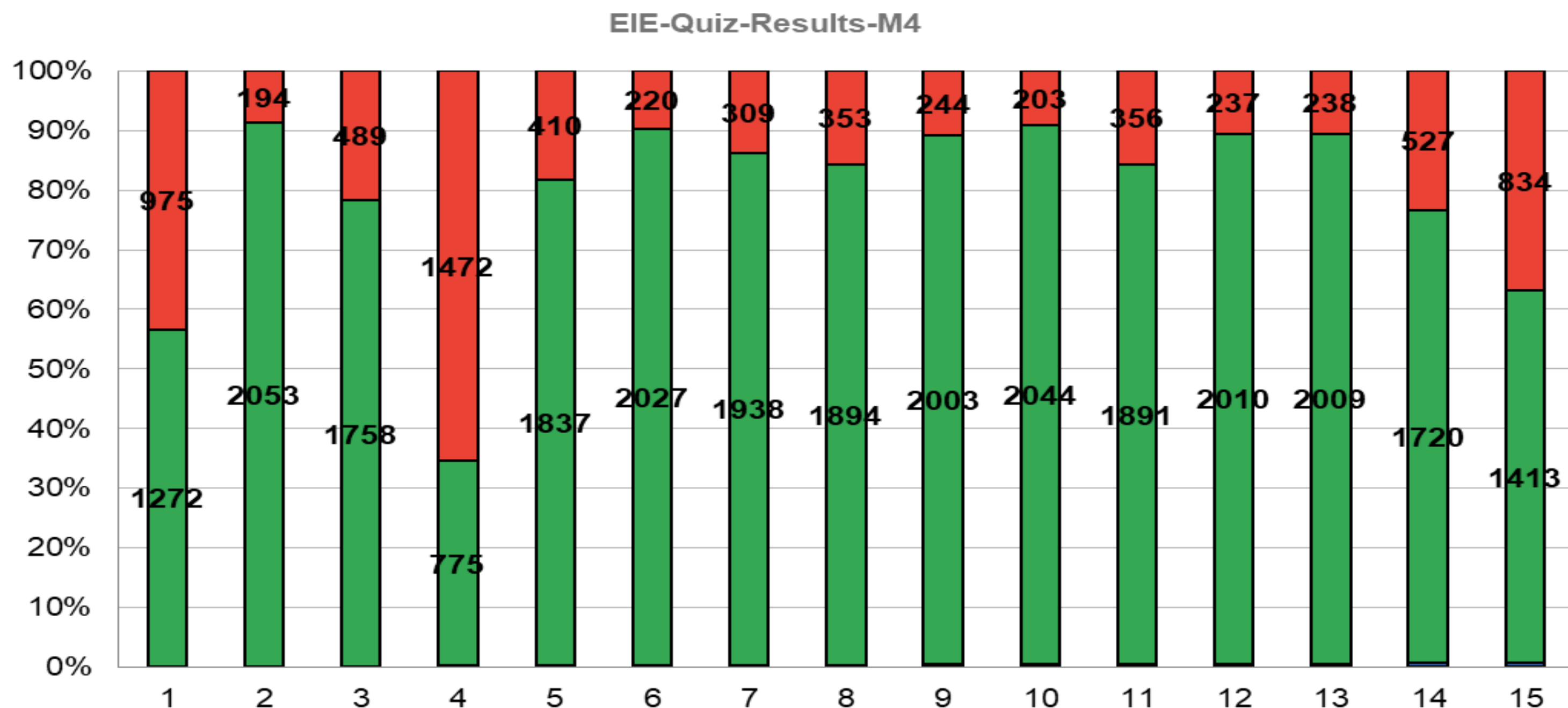
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Module M5 - Human-Centered Innovation

CIE Spark – Tarun

EIE M4 Session – **Poll/Mentimeter** **Results**

EIE M4 Session Quiz - Discussion



EIE M4 Session Quiz - Discussion

1. According to CB Insights, one of the top 3 reasons startups fail is:

- a) Poor marketing
- b) Lack of funding
- c) **Not the right team** - 1272 students got it right!
- d) Weak technology
- e) Slow hiring

4. According to Verna Myers, Inclusion is:

- a) **Being asked to dance** - 775 students got it right!
- b) Being treated fairly in exams
- c) Being offered mentorship
- d) Being included in WhatsApp groups
- e) Being given promotions

15. I am an Engineer or an Architect who basically builds the Product/Solution. Who am I?

- a) Hustler
- b) **Hacker** - 1413 students got it right!
- c) Visionary
- d) Balloon Popper

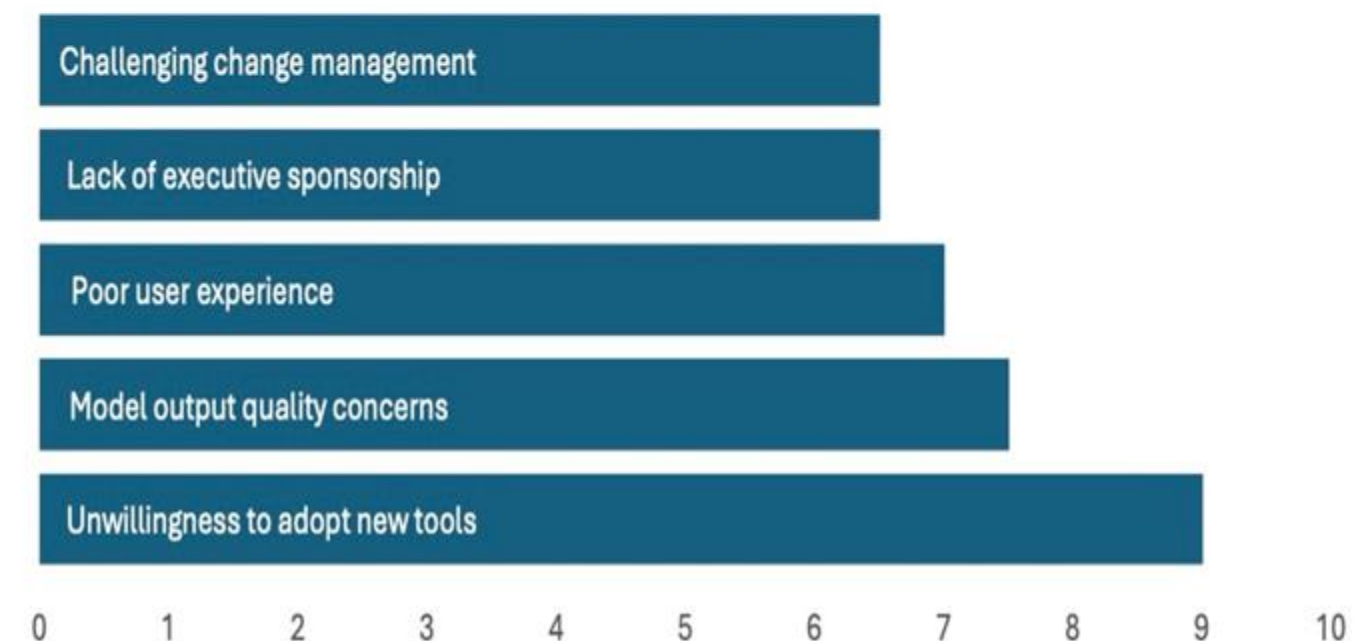
3 for Thought

Now the hard part: making AI useful at work

The early “wow” phase is over, Zoho’s AI head says it’s about **right-sized models, lower costs, and private deployments**. An MIT study shows **most GenAI pilots fail** without workflow fit and change management **skills and process beat shiny demos**.

MIT Shocker: 95% of GenAI Pilots Failing

Exhibit: Why GenAI pilots fail: top barriers to scaling AI in the enterprise
Users were asked to rate each issue on a scale of 1-10



3 for Thought

Governments are jumping in Perplexity opened **free access** to its top models for **U.S. federal employees** with **zero data usage**, plus a special government tier at **\$0.25 per agency for 15 months**, easier trials, tighter security.



3 for Thought

Frontier models keep scaling
Alibaba's **Qwen3-Max** packs **≈1 trillion parameters** and a **262k-token context** via API, powerful for heavy reasoning/coding, but still early; **watch costs and maturity.**



Today's Topics

Human-Centered Innovation

Design Thinking



Credit: Image Creator (Microsoft Bing)

Effectuation





Design Thinking

Participant Opinion

Mentimeter

Join at www.menti.com

use the code: **2803 0382**



Guest Lecture

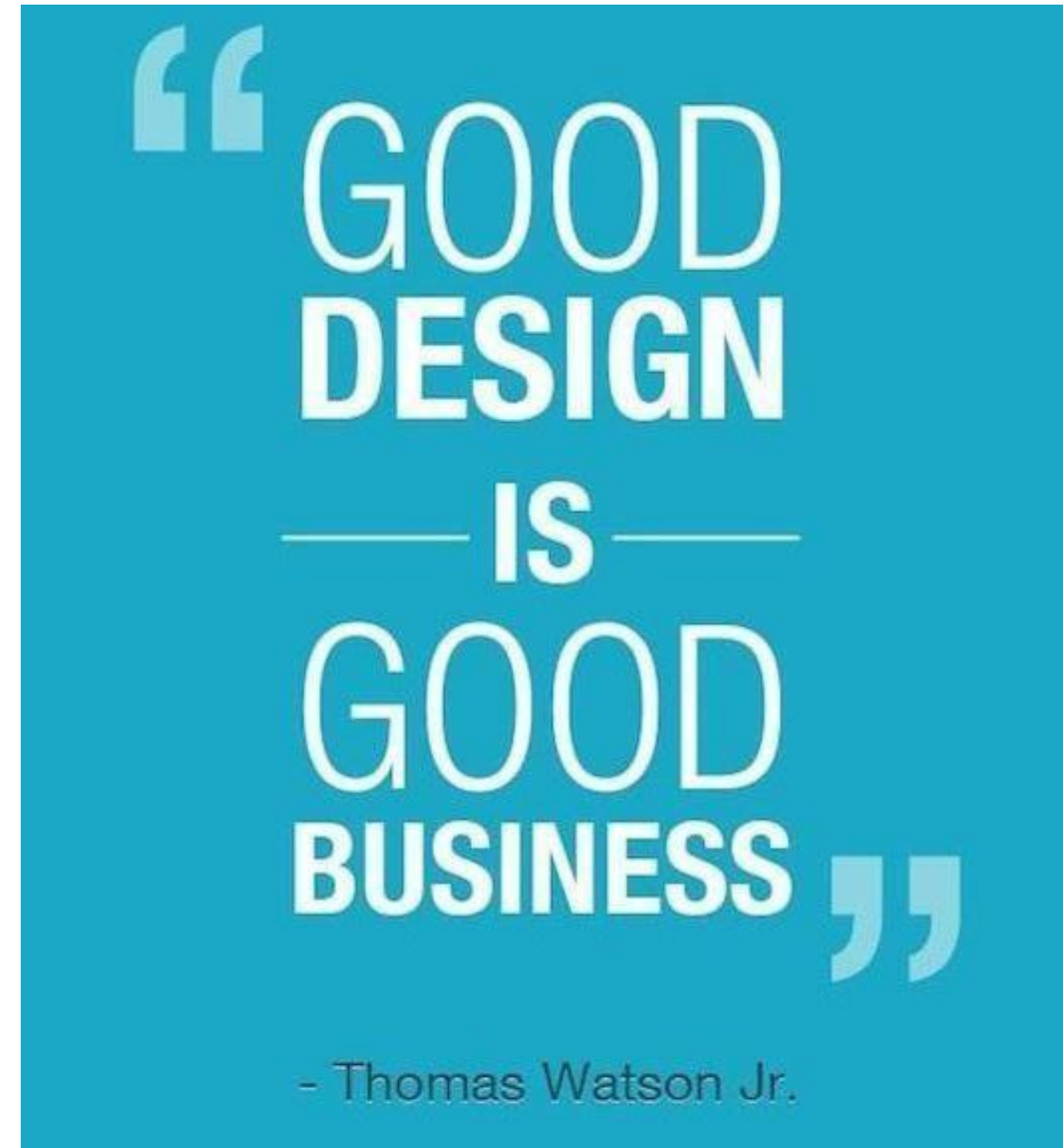
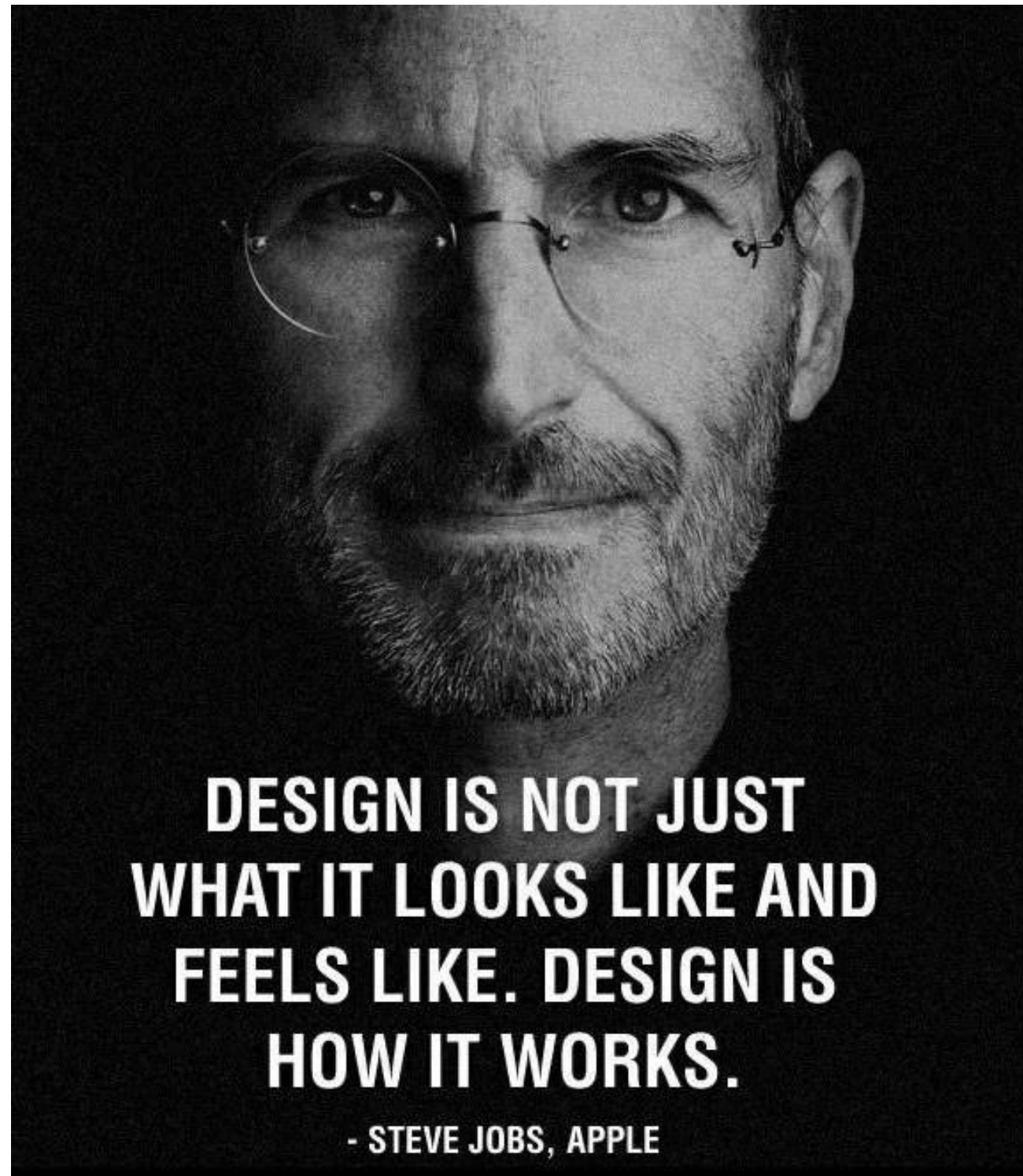


Prof. Chitra Vishwanathan

Director of B.Design Program @PES University

25+ years of professional experience in
Design, Advertising, Entrepreneurship and Teaching

Design



Thinking

*Thinking like a designer
can transform the way
you develop products,
services, processes – and
even strategy.*

Thinking

by Tim Brown

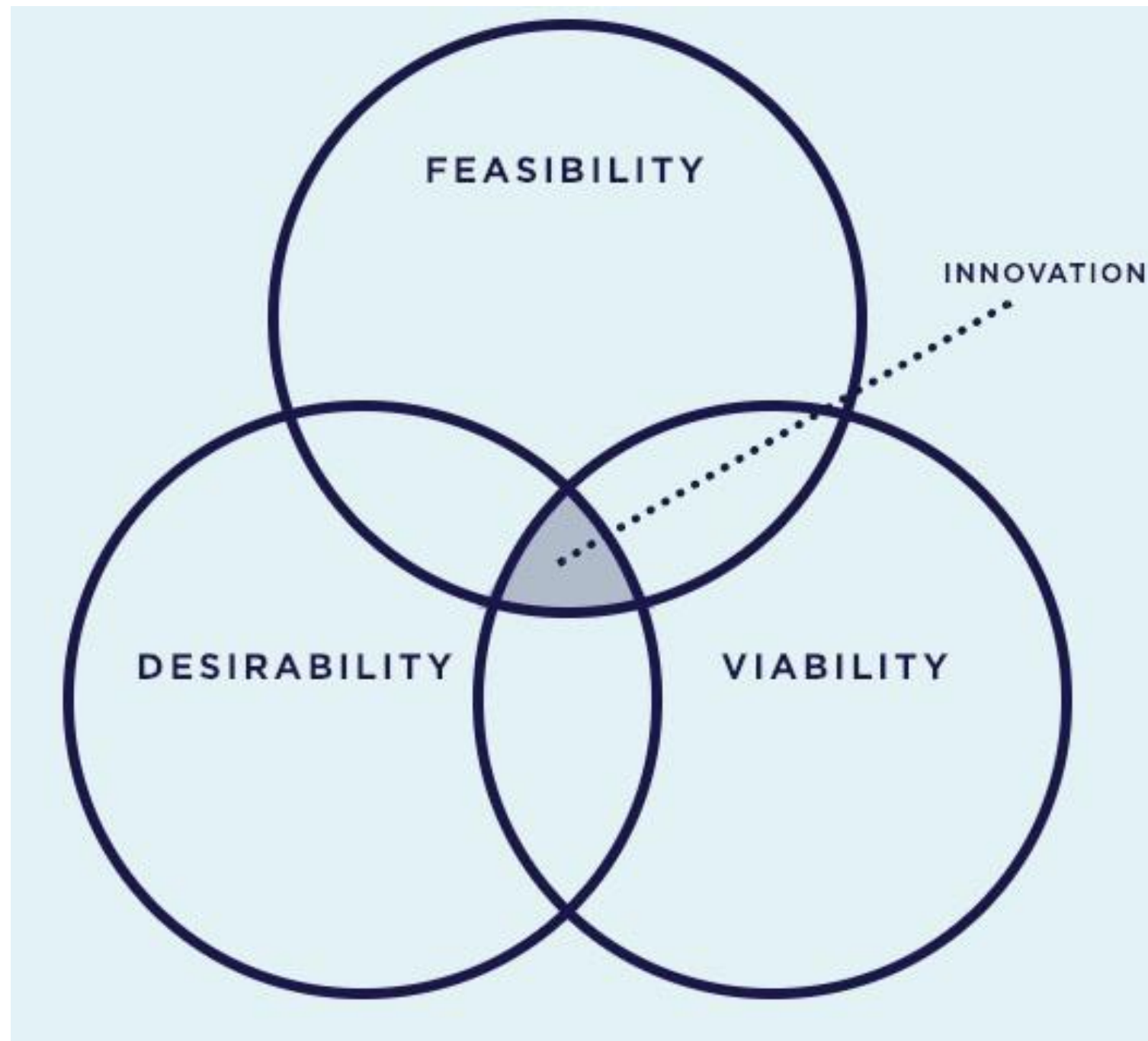
*Leaders now look to innovation as
a principal source of differentiation
and competitive advantage; they
would do well to incorporate
design thinking into all phases of
the process.*

~Tim Brown

Design Thinking: Overview

- Design thinking: A process for creative problem solving
- [IDEO](#) Founder David Kelley, coined the term Design Thinking
- David Kelley founded [d.school](#) (@ Stanford Univ)
- Helped develop Apple's 1st mouse, Palm V PDA, etc.
- Not just Tech, but for Space, Medical, etc (see [here](#) more details)

Design Thinking



Desirability **User**

Feasibility **Tech**

Viability **Business**

Student Volunteer – EIE

- Need ~200 Students for an Experiment that we at CIE are running as a precursor for Spark
- We need Student volunteers to answer a few questions about topics like NABC, Napkin Pitch etc
- This will help us test out a few aspects and allows us to scale for your Ideas during CIE Spark
- Link: <https://forms.gle/RjR7zEkrrnDyTNmFJ9>
- QR:



Why Design Thinking is Important for Innovation & Startups?

- Help you/team surface unmet needs of the people you are creating for
- Generates solutions that are revolutionary, not just incremental
- Reduces the risk associated with launching new ideas

3 Key Principles: (EIE □)

- Empathy
- Ideation
- Experimentation

Design Thinking and Startups

- Design Thinking:

Approach to creating products/services that make a difference to customers

- Have your customers love your product offering
- Better business outcomes

Can also be applied in a wide variety of other areas:

Business design, Leadership, Organizational change, etc

Design Thinking in 90 Seconds (The Strategy Group)



[Link](#) (first 1 min)

Design Thinking (HBR Explainer)

THE EXPLAINER:
**DESIGN
THINKING**

Harvard
Business
Review



[Link](#) (2:17 mins)

TED Talk: Human Centric Innovation:

Mileha Soneji



[Link](#) (7mins)

Activity (Team)

Brainstorming Warmup!

[getting used to Quantity over Quality]

Brainstorm 50 uses of a **Paperclip**
and post them on your team wall!

Design Thinking Mindset



Human-Centered

Deep empathy for user



Ideation

Generating lots of ideas, multiple perspectives



Optimistic

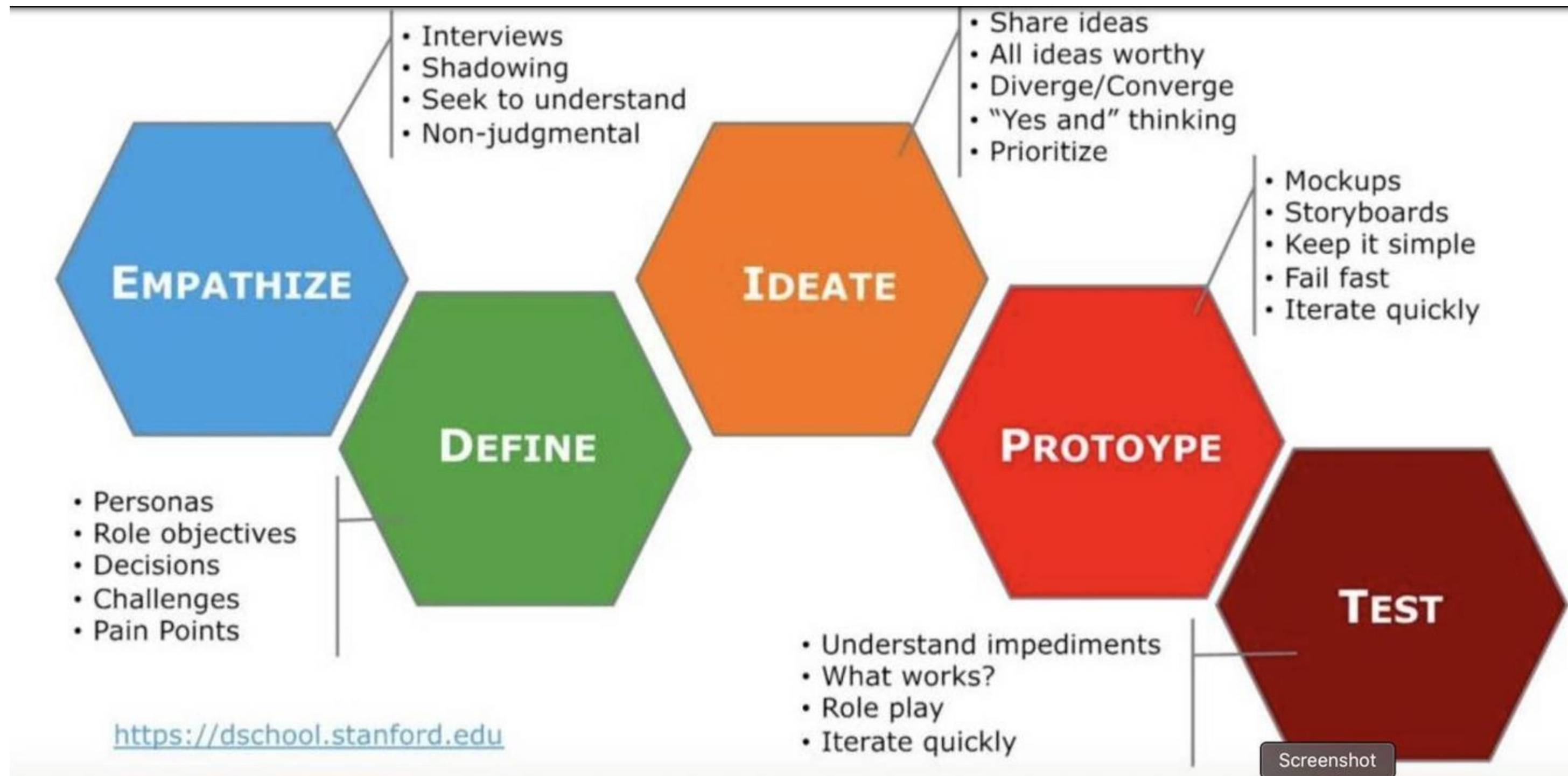
Fundamental belief that we can create change, make a difference to create positive impact



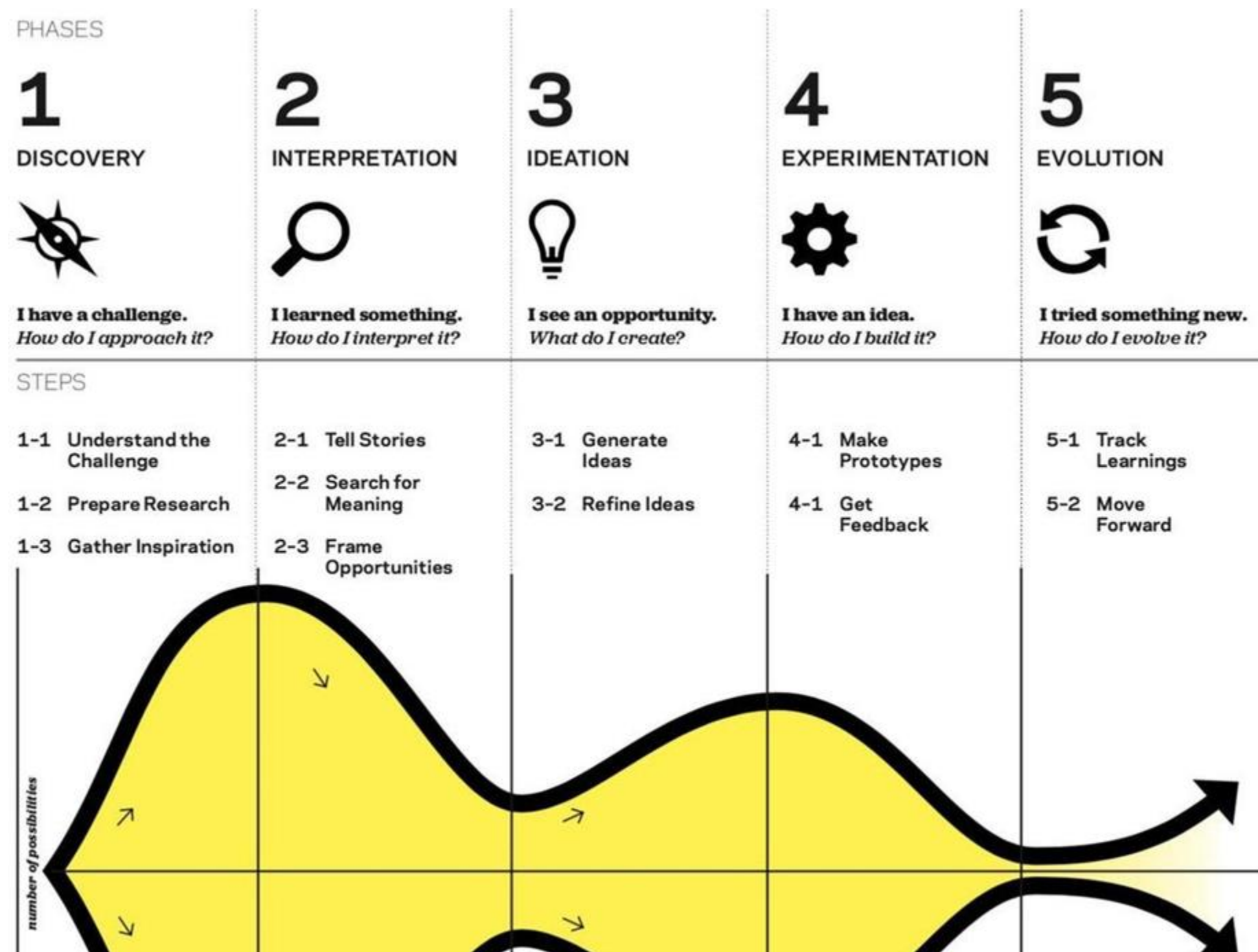
Experimental

Iterate, permission to 'fail' & learn

Design Thinking Framework



Design Thinking Process



1. Discovery

I have a challenge
How do I approach it?

2. Interpretation

I learned something
How do I interpret it?

3. Ideation

I see an opportunity
What do I create?

4. Experimentation

I have an idea
How do I build it?

5. Evolution

I tried something new
How do I evolve it?

IDEO Case Study (Video)

IDEO did the 'Shopping cart project' for ABC News to illustrate their process for coming up with innovative new products:

[IDEO shopping cart project \(15 mins\)](#)

[IDEO shopping cart project \(8 mins\)](#)

Carefully watch to see

- Process (and steps) IDEO employs for new/innovative products
- How they brainstorm effectively and jot down observations
- Rapid prototyping and iterating to come up with a new/improved solution



Effectuation

How Entrepreneurs Build Ventures: Causal logic (conventional wisdom)

- Come up with a brilliant idea
- Show that there is a large market for it
- Write a winning business plan
- Raise money
- Build and grow the venture
- Go public or sell
- Go off to the Bahamas

Effectuation: Another Approach to Getting Started

Video: [A Brief Guide to Effectuation](#) (2:52)

Essential Reading:

[What makes Entrepreneurs Entrepreneurial?](#)

Originator: Dr. Saras Sarasvathy

(Darden School of Business, University of Virginia)

Causal:

Expressing or
indicating cause

relating to or showing the
cause of something

Effectual:

Producing or able to
produce a desired effect

suggest the accomplishment of a
desired result especially as
viewed after the fact

Effectuation

Let's use an Analogy.....

Preparing dinner

When you go to cook dinner how do you cook?

1. Have a specific menu, shop for the ingredients, follow the recipe.
2. Have a look in the fridge, see what's in there and make dinner accordingly



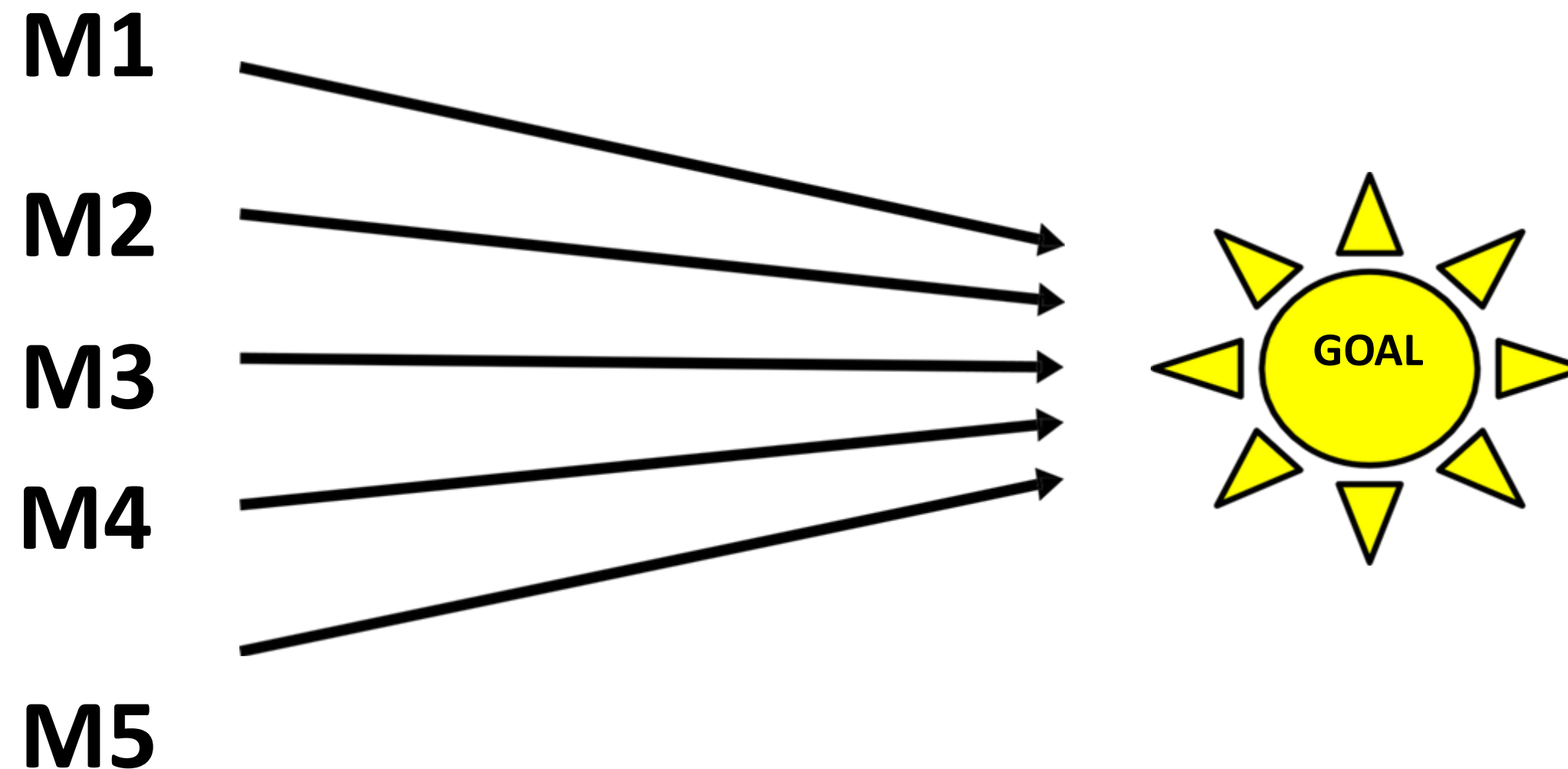
Effectual Logic

Effectual reasoning often requires...



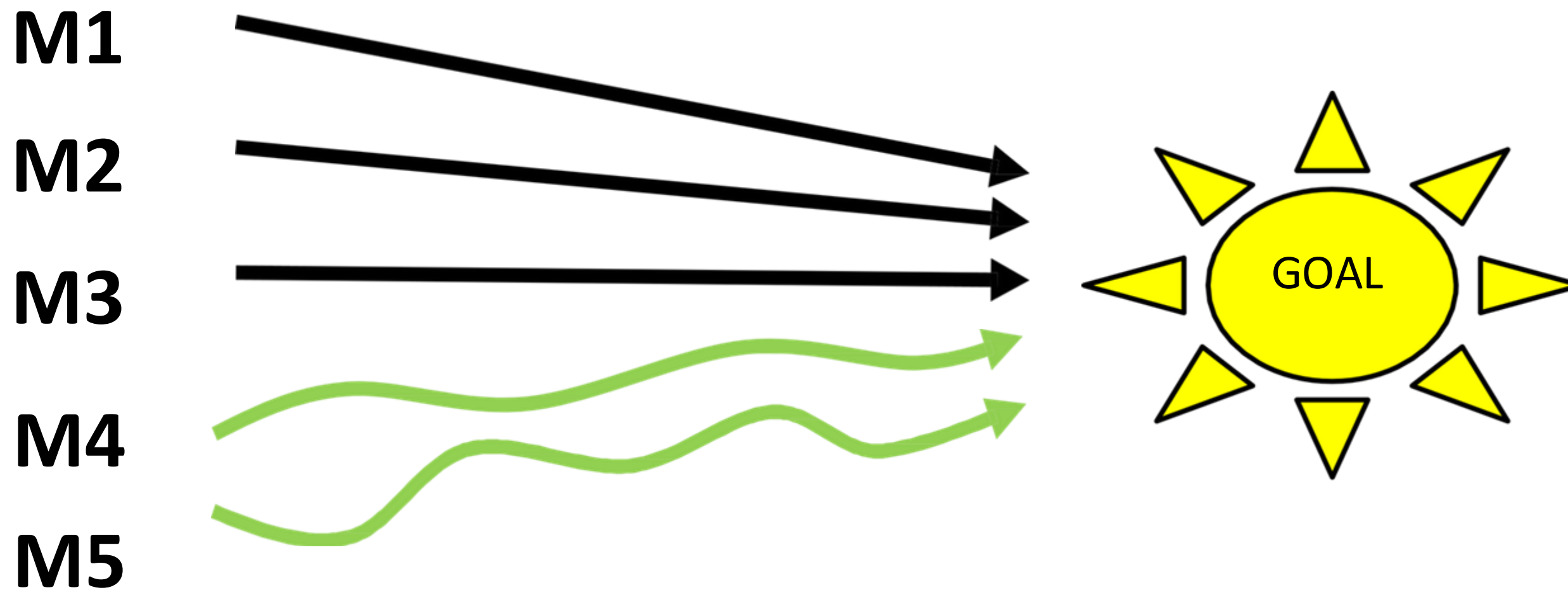
A Managerial Approach

Causal reasoning to achieve a given goal: following pre-existing pathways



A Strategic Approach

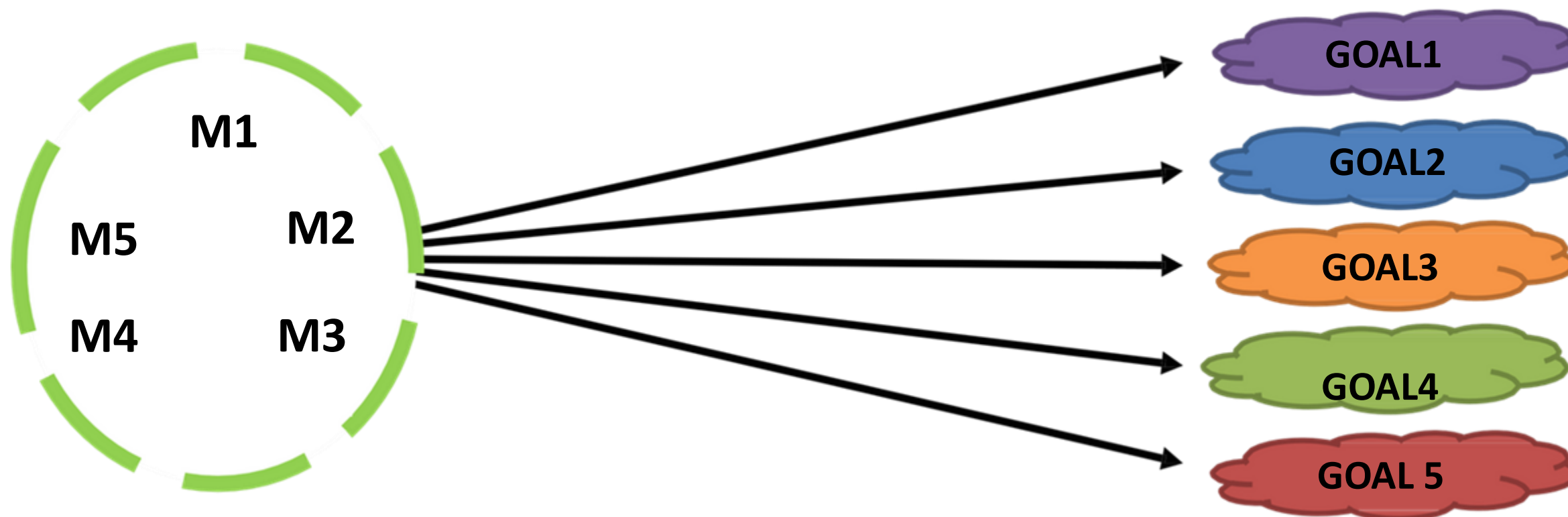
Creative causal reasoning to achieve a given goal:
may involve the creation of new pathways



An Entrepreneurial approach

Effectual reasoning:

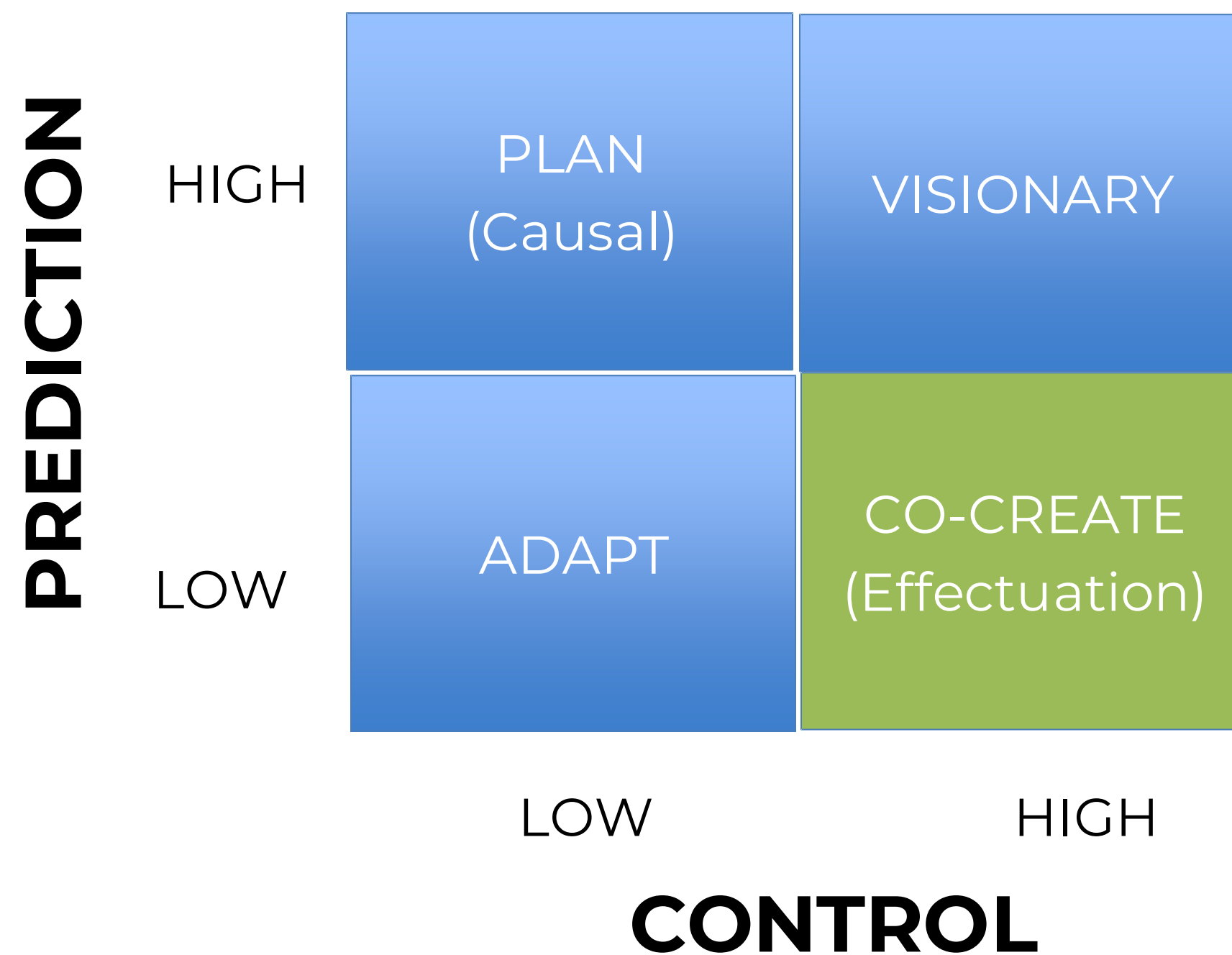
Using a given set of means, start imagining new possibilities



An Effectual Approach

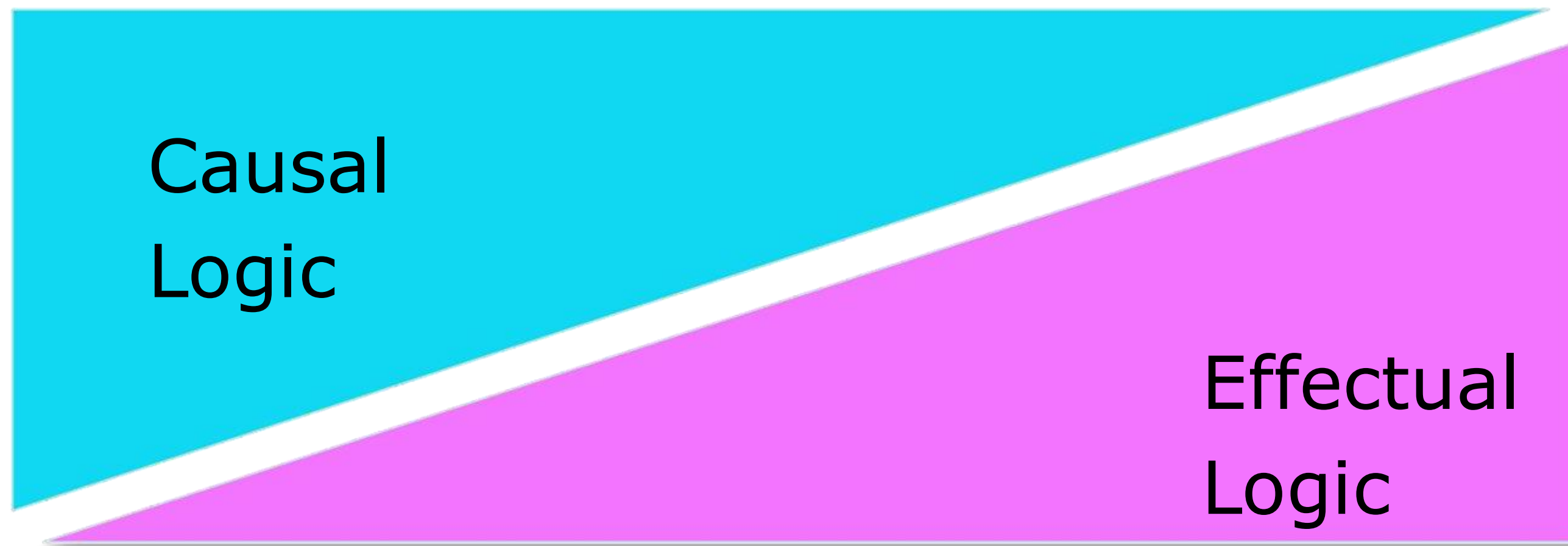
- Effectuation considers entrepreneurship as a series of decisions.
- Decision-making can be applied in ambiguous or uncertain settings.
- Entrepreneurs reimagine outcomes and use means to move into action without elaborate planning.

Non-Predictive Control



The Key Finding

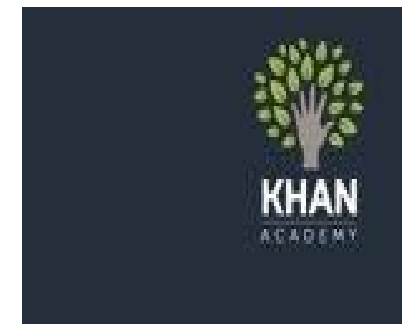
To the extent we can predict the future, we can control it



To an extent we can control the future, we don't need to predict it

Examples of Effectuation

Work with what's already within your control
to co-create the future



Effectuation Example

An illustration of the effectual process carried out by mompreneurs

From an exploratory research of French mompreneurs, d'Andria [DAN 14] highlights the effectual logic of their entrepreneurial process. Results suggest that the theory of effectuation is an appropriate and innovative framework for understanding mompreneur business creation.

Mompreneurs decide to start-up business in agreement with their means and in a relatively short time:

– I was watching TV; they presented young people in the process of raising funds. And I said to myself: If they succeed, why not me? (...) and I created my company before having defined my project.

Effectuation Example

They define acceptable losses:

- *To start my company, I used family savings.*
- *I started small, with just 30,000 euros to buy products to start and see if it could work.*

They build a network:

- *I talked about it, and then I formed a small team of testing mothers.*
- *When you do not know how to do it, you just have to ask for advice and surround yourself with skills from the network of friends or relationships established during your professional life.*



Principles Of Effectuation

Bird-in-Hand Principle



Start with your means

Start with Who you are, What you know, & Whom you know

When expert entrepreneurs set out to build a new venture, they start with their means:

- Who I am, what I know, and whom I know
- Then, the entrepreneurs imagine possibilities that originate from their means.

Affordable Loss Principle

Focus on the Downside Risk

Invest what you can afford to lose – extreme case \$0

- Expert entrepreneurs limit risk by understanding what they can afford to lose at each step, instead of seeking large all-or-nothing opportunities.
- They choose goals and actions where there is an upside even if the downside ends up happening.



Lemonade Principle



Leverage Contingencies:

Embrace and Leverage surprises

- Expert entrepreneurs invite the surprise factor
- Instead of making “what-if” scenarios to deal with the worst-case scenarios, experts interpret “bad” news & surprises as potential clues to create new markets.

Crazy Quilt Principle



Form partnerships:

Build a network of self-selected stakeholders

- Expert entrepreneurs build partnerships with self-selecting stakeholders.
- By obtaining pre-commitments from these key partners early on in the venture, experts reduce uncertainty and co-create new market with its interested participants.

Pilot-in-the-Plane Principle



Pilot-in-the-plane principle:

Co-create the future

By focusing on activities within their control, expert entrepreneurs know their actions will result in the desired outcomes.

**An effectual worldview is rooted in the
belief**

**that the future is neither found nor
predicted**

but rather CREATED

Summary of Effectuation Process



Summary Of Effectuation Principles

Means

BIRD-IN HAND



Bird in Hand Principle

Who you are, What you know, & Whom you know (Not pre-set goals/opps)

Affordable Loss

FOCUS ON
DOWNSIDE



Affordable Loss Principle

Invest what you can afford to lose –extreme case \$0 (Not expected return)

Leverage
Contingencies

LEMONADE



Lemonade Principle

Embrace and Leverage

(Not avoid them)

Co-Creation
Partnership

CRAZY QUILT



Crazy-Quilt Principle

surprises

Build a network of self-selected stakeholders (Not competitive analysis)

Worldview:

CONTROL vs. PREDICTION



Pilot-in-the-Plane Principle

Co-create the future (Not stick to a pre-determined path)

For details, see <https://effectuation.org/the-five-principles-of-effectuation>

When to use Effectuation



EFFECTUAL LOGIC IS
LIKE 1ST & 2ND GEAR



You need them to start your business but eventually you shift away from effectual logic

effectuation **IS**

A thinking framework
a set of heuristics
doing the do-able
how to get the sellable products and
services established

effectuation **IS NOT**

a system to tell you what to do
an algorithm
“not planning”
a way to launch an entire business

Entrepreneurship Mindset Effectuation

Effectuation and Entrepreneurial Mindset Go Hand in Hand

Effectuation	Entrepreneurship Mindset Elements
Bird-in-Hand Principle:	Imaginative, Creative, Resourcefulness, Adaptability
Affordable Loss Principle	Calculated Risk-taking, Learning from Failures
Crazy Quilt Principle	Networking, Relationship-building, Collaborative
Lemonade Principle	Courage, Growth-mindset, Optimist
Pilot-in-a-Plane Principle	Flexibility, Agility, Adaptability

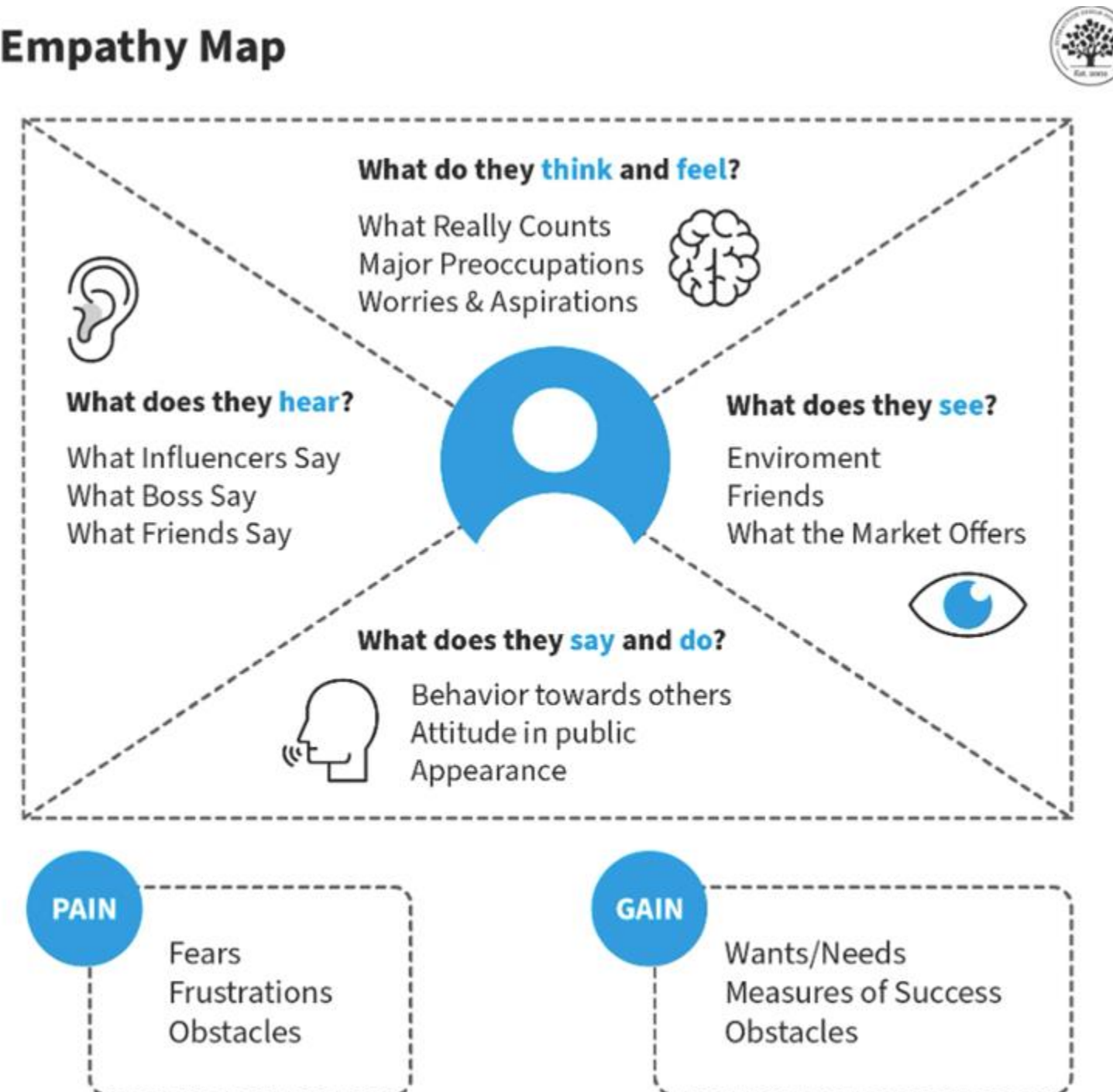
Other Commonalities between Effectuation & Entrepreneurship Mindset:

Action-oriented, Embracing Uncertainty, Leveraging existing Resources, Iterative Approach

Post-Session Activity: Empathy Map

For a given set of customers facing a given challenge/problem, create an empathy map

Empathy Map



Post-Session Activity: Effectuation

Effectuation Activity: The Lemonade Stand Challenge *<or something you are most excited to start>*

Objective: To apply the effectuation principles to create a small-scale entrepreneurial venture.

Instructions:

1. **Brainstorm a product or service:** Consider your skills, interests, and resources. Think about a product or service you could create or offer with minimal investment.
2. **Identify your existing resources:** Make a list of the resources you already have, such as time, skills, contacts, and equipment.
3. **Set a small, achievable goal:** Instead of aiming for a grand vision, start with a modest goal. For example, if you're selling lemonade, aim to sell a certain number of cups per day.
4. **Create a prototype or sample:** Even if it's a simple version, having a tangible product or service will help you gather feedback.
5. **Test your idea:** Share your product or service with friends, family, or classmates. Ask for their feedback and suggestions.
6. **Iterate and improve:** Based on the feedback you receive, make adjustments to your product or service.
7. **Leverage your network:** Reach out to people you know to see if they can help you connect with potential customers or partners.
8. **Start small and grow gradually:** Avoid making large investments upfront. Instead, focus on generating revenue and reinvesting your profits to grow your business.

Additional Considerations:

- **Time constraints:** Consider the amount of time you have available to dedicate to the project.
- **Budget:** Set a budget for your venture and stick to it.
- **Legal and regulatory requirements:** Ensure that your venture complies with any relevant laws and regulations.
- **Reflection:** Write a reflection on your experience. Discuss the challenges you faced, the lessons you learned, and how you applied the principles of effectuation.

Session Feedback

Mentimeter

Join at www.menti.com
use the code: **6683 0460**



Session Quiz

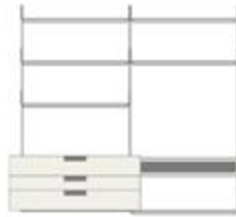
Please take the Session Quiz on PESU Academy now

Thank You!

why is *everyone* talking about design?

September 2025
Chitra Viswanathan

**because we are all
surrounded by design and
are products of it.**

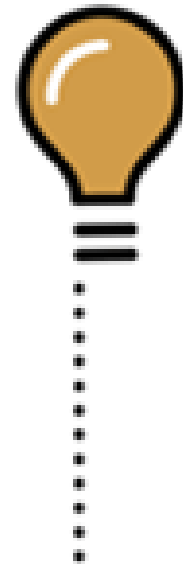


what is design thinking?

**The process of creating solutions
using creative problem solving
techniques**

a human centred approach –

through a deeper understanding of people we can identify and create more successful solutions. The starting point for any innovation is to truly understand people – this is the foundation of design thinking.



This five-phase model proposed by the Hasso-Plattner Institute of Design at Stanford and is at the forefront of applying and teaching Design Thinking. The five phases of Design Thinking, according to D.School Stanford, are as follows:

empathise – with your users

define – your users' needs, their problem, and your insights

ideate – by challenging assumptions and creating ideas for innovative solutions

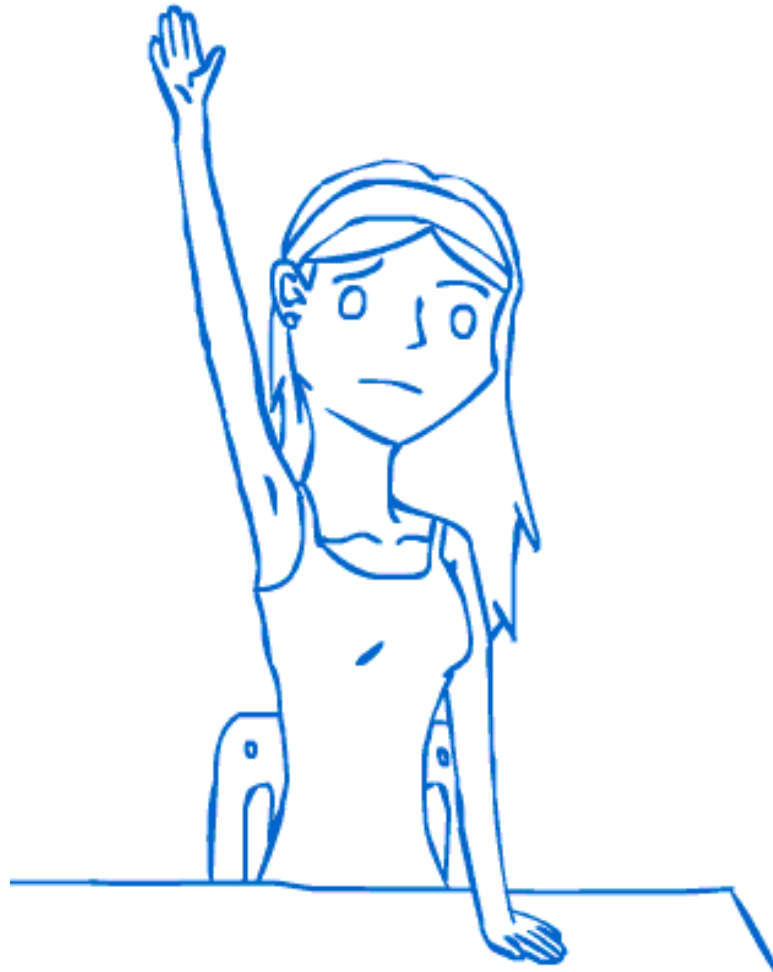
prototype – to start creating solutions

test – solutions

What qualities should a good designer have?

The spirit of enquiry

GK + Curiosity



entertainer

imagination + risk



visual mind



and great story telling



**Every iconic design
that we know, arose
from someone's
need, and more
importantly someone
noticing and
addressing this
need!**

**Design thinking is
actually realising
that your customer
is your biggest
influencer!**

It's a Human Thing!



and to get here
is a constant
exercise in
empathy!



just do it!



why do it?





**the 'bendy'
straw-1937**

**sometimes whimsical.
sometimes romantic
sometimes a happy accident**

**but the creation of a new product/
design, always fulfils a need**

**design
has to
work**

/

**art
does
not**

**and designs will
work only
because . . .**

**#1-thinking outside
of the box**

**# 2- the power of the
narrative**

the power of storytelling!

**stories are
remembered up to 22
times more than facts**

facts and numbers don't trigger or create emotional resonance, nor do they remind, relate to, or connect times, places, and objects to its audience. But, phenomenal and innovative stories do!

This means humans, consumers, your customers, everyone is hard wired to listen to a strong story that resonates with them. When brand stories are compelling enough they embed in the mind of its listeners — they are then shared and re-shared.



the power of storytelling!

- let your product tell a story
- let your packaging tell a story
- let your branding tell a story
- let your idea tell a story



the sweetest story ever

the most successful packaging story of all time

This iconic contour fluted lines of the Coca-Cola bottle has been celebrated in art, music, and advertising globally for over 100 years now and has become one of the most recognized objects of the twentieth century.



the curvy hobble skirt, 1915

the luckiest accident in graphic design history

FedEx®

a tape recorder that does not record

Thirty years ago, the idea of people walking around with headphones on whilst listening to music seemed insane. Now, it's something we barely notice, but what piece of design created this change in behaviour?



a defining
accessory
of the
'ME'
decade

the shoot, pull, & shake design

polaroid
camera



Polaroid is taking a stand against screen addiction, AI fatigue, and algorithmic overload with its latest campaign, 'The Camera for an Analogue Life', launched to support the release of its newest instant camera, Flip.



camera for an analog life



polaroid

DOESN'T
CONNECT TO
THE CLOUD



DOES CONNECT
YOU TO
EACH OTHER.

New Polaroid Flip



The camera for an analogue life.

JCDcaux

16:09

camera for an analog life

JCDecaux

polaroid

REMEMBER
THAT NIGHT
WE SPENT ON
OUR PHONES?



ME NEITHER.

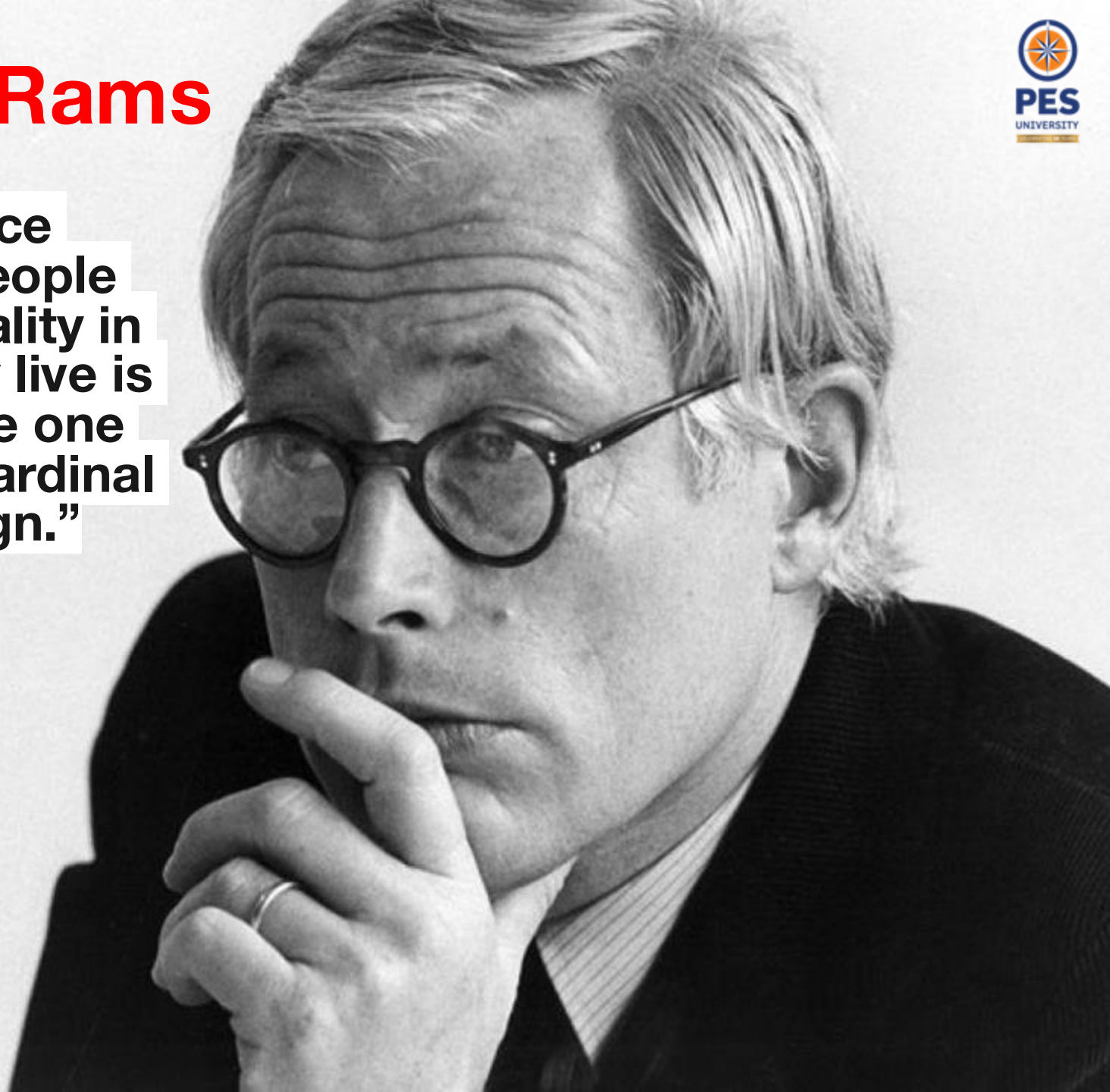


New Polaroid Flip
The camera for an analog life.



Dieter Rams

“Indifference towards people and the reality in which they live is actually the one and only cardinal sin in design.”



Dieter Rams

BRAUN



Dieter Rams



Braun T3 Pocket Radio
(1958)



Apple iPod
(2001)



Braun ET44
(1977)



Apple iPhone
(2007)



Braun LE1 Speaker
(1959)



Apple iMac
(2007)



Braun T1000 Radio
(1967)



Power Mac G5
(2003)

Dieter Rams

Good design is innovative

Good design makes a product useful

Good design is aesthetic

Good design makes a product understandable

Good design is unobtrusive



Dieter Rams

Good design is honest

Good design is long-lasting

Good design is thorough down to the last detail

Good design is environmentally-friendly

Good design is as little design as possible



“I'm dating my iPhone.”



“The best ideas start as conversations.”



The chief icon of a new religion

**‘It is modest but
monumental:
nothing needs to
be added, nothing
needs to be taken
away. It is the
perfect thing’**



The unboxing of a new religion



with this in mind, it may be more correct to say that

“design thinking is not about thinking outside of the box, but on its edge, its corner, its flap, and under its barcode.”

-Clint Runge

thank you:)